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SCHOOL DEVELOPMENT PLAN UNDER THE RIGHT TO EDUCATION ACT 2009

**SCHOOL MAPPING AND MICRO-PLANNING -
PARTICIPATORY TOOL FOR SCHOOL DEVELOPMENT PLAN**

Dayaram

BOOK TWO

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SCHOOL DEVELOPMENT PLAN UNDER THE RIGHT TO EDUCATION ACT 2009
School Mapping and Micro-planning — Participatory Tool for School Development Plan

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TABLE OF CONTENTS

FOREWORD	6
CHAPTER ONE: INDIA'S SCHOOL EDUCATION PUZZLE	8
1. The Indian Education System and the Right to Education Act	8
2. The School Education Landscape in India	9
2.1 Poor Learning Outcomes	9
2.2 Great Divide in the Indian School Education System	10
2.3 Defeatist and Cynical Outlook Pervading the System	10
2.4 Scholls Unable to Deal with First-Generation Learners	11
3. Prospects	12
3.1 The RTE Act, 2009 - An Opportunity not to be Wasted	12
3.2 Stress on Governance and Accountability in the Act	13
3.3 Parents and Teachers As Key Stakeholders	13
3.4 SMCs and LSGs Are Important Instruments for Transforming Schools	14
4. Brief Review of School Reforms Efforts in India	14
4.1 Key Achievements	14
4.2 Key Challenges	15
4.3 DPEP and SSA	15
4.3.1 Twin Challenges of Governance and Pedagogy	17
4.3.2 Concurrent List Status of Education and Centrally Sponsored Schemes	18
4.3.3 Top-Down Generic Approaches Failed to Deliver	18
5. Implementation of the RTE ACT: 2009–2012 — The Trend So Far	19
6. People Become Part Of The Change	20
6.1 Who takes initiative for change?	20
CHAPTER TWO: PERSPECTIVE ON DECENTRALISATION	22
1. Understanding the Politics of Decentralization	22
2. Decentralization — An Important Opportunity for Civil Society Organizations	24

CHAPTER THREE: SCHOOL MAPPING & MICROPLANNING A PARTICIPATORY TOOL FOR PLANNING

	26
1. School Mapping And Micro-Planning	26
2. Evolution of School Mapping & Micro-planning	27
3. School Mapping and Micro-Planning under RTE	28
3.1 Key Steps of School Mapping and Micro-planning	28
4. Community Mobilization	29
5. Issues that Require Special Emphasis	31
5.1 Important role of the community	31
5.2 Formation of the Planning Team	32
5.3 Training the Planning Team	32
5.3.1 Some key aspects to be covered in the training	32
5.4 Developing a Vision of a Good School	32
5.4.1 Assessing the Current Perception	33
5.4.2 Sharing Some Other Visions	33
5.4.3 Developing a Shared Vision	33
6. Preparing Profile of the Village	33
7. Preparing a Nazari Naksha of a Village	33
8. Household Survey	35
8.1 Main Steps of the Survey	36
9. School Survey/Assessment	36
10. Comparing DISE Data with HH Survey Data	36
11. Compiling Data by using Appropriate Formats and Analysis after Verification	36
12. Diagnosis	37
13. Focus Group Discussion (FGD)	37
14. Discussing Possible Strategies for Achieving UEE	38
15. Finalizing Interventions in Consultation with the Community	38
16. Preparing a Three-Year Workplan and an Annual Workplan	38

TABLE OF CONTENTS *(continued)*

CHAPTER FOUR: PREPARING SCHOOL DEVELOPMENT PLAN	40
1. School Development Plan	40
2. Formulating School Development Plan	42
2.1 Universal Access	42
2.2 Universal Coverage	43
2.3 Physical Infrastructure	43
2.4 Teacher Requirement	44
2.5 Teacher Training	44
2.6 Universal Participation	46
2.7 Learning Achievement	46
2.8 Universal Retention and Promotion	47
2.9 School Sports, Arts, and Music	49
2.9.1 Games and Sports	49
2.9.2 Arts and Music	49
2.10 School Children's Health	49
2.11 Budgeting	50
2.12 Implementation Plan and the Timeline with Major Milestones	50
3. Using Village Education Register (VER) for Tracking Progress of Every Child	50
 CHAPTER FIVE: STORIES OF CHANGE	 52
1. SMC's Struggle for Creating A Safe School Environment for Children	52
2. SMC Succeeds in Getting Safe Drinking water for Schools	54
3. SMC's Activism Ensure Teachers Being Punctual to School	55
4. SMCs With Support from LAMP Succeeded in Getting Sanction from SSA for Seasonal Hostels	55
5. SMC Succeeds in Creating Consensus Among Community on Accessing Incentive for Children	56
6. SMC Intervention Help Improving Teaching Community Relationship	56

7. SMC Ensures Safe School Building for the Children	56
8. SMCs Intervention to Ensure Regular and Proper Supply of Mid-Day Meal in School	59
ANNEX: SCHOOL DEVELOPMENT PLAN	60
1. Introduction	
2. Process of School Development Plan Preparation	
3. School Catchment Area and Number of Habitations in the Neighborhood of the School	
4. Number of Children 4-5 Years Age	
5. Enrollment - Projection of Enrollment in Three Years (2012-13, 2013-14, 2014-15)	
6. Teacher	
7. Infrastructure	
8. Action Plan for Enrollment of out of School Children and Ensuring Retention	
9. Plan of Retention of Children	
10. Plan for Children with Special Needs	
11. Planning for Ensuring Quality Education in School	
12. Planning to Strengthen School-Community Linkage	
13. Provision of Corpus Fund	
14. Other Requirements in the School	
15. Summary of School Development Plan (With Financial Implication)	
16. Sources of Funding	
GLOSSARY OF TERMS	78

FOREWORD

Improving efficiency of the public education system in India remains a major national challenge before policy makers, planners and practitioners. There have been many interventions since independence to ensure quality education for mass of the children without any significant success. A great hierarchy exists within the school education system in India. Equality of opportunity in terms of accessing education has remained at best a political rhetoric. India's affluent class, who can afford to pay a considerable sum for its children's education send their children to expensive private schools, while for the majority of the population poorly equipped and barely functional government schools are the sole option. The social and economic divide that exists in the society is reflected in access to schools as well.

The government-run school system again is heterogeneous. On the one hand we have single-teacher, building less, multi-grade Education Guarantee Scheme (EGS) schools, while on the other we have a category of comfortably funded *Kendriya Vidyalayas* (Central Schools) and *Navodaya Vidyalayas*, which primarily cater to children of central government employees and the rural elites.

One of the main reasons for the miserable state of our public system of schools lies in this divide. The section which controls power and resources has no real stake in government schools as its children mostly go to private schools. Other important reasons include local communities having little say in the management of schools, extremely weak teacher training institutions, teachers' inability to deal with first generation learners which are large in numbers, all pervasive rent seeking attitude in the functionaries and a situation of hopelessness regarding change, and other things. The Right to Education (RTE) Act, 2009 provides for necessary and improved infrastructure. It also seeks to include all children in schools by providing them with special training. It provides for adequate number of trained and qualified teachers to be placed in every school within a certain timeframe. The number of teachers needed is required to be calculated for each school, based on RTE norms. This provision of providing teachers to every school based on number of students should be able to weed out the chronic problems of teacher shortage and irrational deployment of teachers.

The Act also provides opportunity for changing school education landscape by stressing on decentralized planning and management of schools. Local Self-Government and the School Management Committee (SMC), which primarily consists of the parents of schoolchildren, have been assigned significant roles and responsibilities under the Act. An important role assigned to the SMC is of preparing school development plans by using the School Mapping and Micro-Planning tool.

This is a key provision, which will go a long way in enhancing school efficiency. Having a decent school infrastructure and an adequate number of qualified teachers are very important to a system overhaul, but these alone will not accomplish much unless school management is improved. When the system seems to be crippled and has lost the necessary force within itself to get out of the present crisis, the energy and push for change has to come from the outside, from the community. There are ample examples of organized and active community taking charge of their schools and bringing substantial improvement in their functioning across the globe. Communities, supported by civil society organizations, have been able to reverse the continuing downfall of schools by first establishing a positive relationship with the schools and then halting the tide of defeatism within the establishment, particularly the teachers in schools in many parts of our country.



For communities to be able to discharge this transformative function, they need to be organized, facilitated and provided with necessary forums and tools to engage with the schools at the local level and for the collectives of communities with the level of school system.

The School Mapping and Micro-Planning is one such important tool for community to plan for quality education for their children. The processes described are participatory and empowering. These processes and tools have evolved and have got refined over the years in the course of doing community based planning for school development, during the programmes such as Lok Jumbis-hand and Learning And Migration Programme (LAMP) supported by American India Foundation. The tools and processes described have been product of the consultative and participatory processes. I am confident that this will help community organizations at the grassroots to prepare their school development plans and also prove an effective tool for engaging with the school for improving its functioning. I hope the entire process will be enriching and empowering for the community and the development workers engaged in education.

A.K. Jalaluddin
New Delhi



CHAPTER ONE: INDIA'S SCHOOL EDUCATION PUZZLE

1. THE INDIAN EDUCATION SYSTEM AND THE RIGHT TO EDUCATION ACT

The Right of Children to Free and Compulsory Education Act, 2009, known commonly as the Right to Education (RTE) Act, is a landmark legislation for ensuring children's right to free and compulsory elementary education. Decentralized governance of school education is one of the key pillars of the Act.

To achieve this, Local Self-Government (LSG) agencies and the School Management Committee (SMC), which primarily consists of the parents of school children, have been assigned significant roles and responsibilities under the Act. An important role the SMC is assigned is that of preparing school development plans by using the School Mapping and Micro-Planning (SM&MP) tool. This is one of the most important provisions of the RTE Act, in which lies the potential to revive the country's almost defunct government school system, catering primarily to the children from the marginalized sections of the society.¹

¹ Children belonging to the marginalized groups constitute majority among the school-age children, above 70 per cent in India. Government schools remain their only option as their economic condition does not allow them to opt for (fee paying) private schools.



2. THE SCHOOL EDUCATION LANDSCAPE IN INDIA

India's government managed school education system, which caters to about 77 per cent of school-age children, remains deficient on many counts. Despite many inputs into improving school education in India since Independence, there is still a huge deficit which needs to be addressed. Several regions in the country continue to have extremely scarce educational resources. While almost all children enroll in school at the primary level, less than 20 per cent graduate from high school. Meaningful access, participation, completion and quality of learning outcomes remain a distant dream for many children.

For India's vast public education system, comprising more than 1.4 million schools, 220 million children, and above six million teachers, it is indeed an enormous challenge to ensure quality education for its children.

2.1 POOR LEARNING OUTCOMES

The government managed school education does not deliver quality learning to children. About 50 per cent of children in fifth grade in rural India are unable to read second grade textbooks.² The Global Monitoring Report (2007) ranks India at a low 100 amongst the 125 countries on the Education for All (EFA) Development Index, based upon progress related to universal primary education, adult literacy, gender parity, and the quality of education. The Program for Interna-

² Annual Status Of Education Report 2011

tional Student Assessment (PISA) report places India at the bottom, just above Kyrgyzstan.³

This abysmally low outcome of education poses a serious challenge to India's economic development as well as to its democratic fabric. It also has a crippling effect on India's growth, because its emerging workforce is unable to cope with the demands of the twenty-first century economy.

2.2 GREAT DIVIDE IN THE INDIAN SCHOOL EDUCATION SYSTEM

Before proceeding further, it would be pertinent to take a look at what ails India's Education system. It is ironical that education can be a great leveler and also a means of perpetuating the existing social divide. A hierarchy of schools exists in India. Equality of opportunity in terms of accessing school has remained at best a political rhetoric. India's middle class, which can afford to pay a considerable sum for its children's education, opts to send its children to expensive private schools while for the majority of the population, poorly equipped and barely functional government schools are the sole option.⁴ The social and economic divide that exists in society is reflected in access to schools as well.

The government school system in India caters in the main to the marginalized sections of our society, which constitute about 77 per cent of the Indian population. The extremely poor quality of education imparted here ensures that the large majority of children are consistently lagging far behind others.

One of the main reasons for the dismal state of our public system of schools is that the socially and economically dominant sections of the society have no real stake in them, as their children attend private schools. Another important reason is that the local communities do not have much of a say in the management of government schools.

This gap in access to educational opportunity between the privileged and the common people is leading to creation of an ever-widening income gap within the country between the well-educated and the poorly educated low-skill workforce.

2.3 DEFEATIST AND CYNICAL OUTLOOK PERVADE THE SYSTEM

The Government School System is far too large and rigid. It does not encourage new ideas and fresh thinking from the teachers and the field functionaries. Compliance to bureaucratic orders is rewarded; innovation is hardly accorded any value. A culture of non-accountability and non-performance has become so pervasive within the system and has been around for so many decades that it has almost become a norm. So much so that questions about it are being raised even by people from outside the system; those internal to the system are unable to view non-accountability and non-performance as an anomaly. In any system, if the problem has permeated deep enough to become part of the work culture, change becomes that much more difficult and complex to bring about.

The silver lining one witnesses, however, is that the system is slowly emerging from its denial about nonperformance and poor accountability. Some system functionaries are beginning to acknowledge and grapple with the lack of performance and accountability; at the same time, they are unable to comprehend the reasons for these failures, and subsequently the possible remedies for the same. Faced with excessive criticism without any solutions, the functionaries are turning cynical and very often getting caught in a negative spiral of passing the blame to others.

³ PISA is administered every three years, and each administration includes assessments of three subjects: reading, mathematics, and science. One of these subjects is assessed in depth.

⁴ The government-run school system is extremely hierarchical. On the one hand it has single-teacher, building less, multi-grade Education Guarantee Scheme (EGS) schools, while on the other there are comfortably funded *Kendriya Vidyalayas* (Central Schools) and *Navodaya Vidyalayas*, which caters mainly to the children of central government employees and the rural elites.

This inability to clearly comprehend the problems afflicting the school system is also contributing towards this defeatist and cynical outlook. The blame, more often than not, travels down and stops at the doorstep of the hapless teacher.

Excessive criticism without relevant solutions is causing teachers to have a defeatist attitude. Teacher-bashing is common during educational discourses. There is an overwhelming tendency of blaming teachers for all the ills of the system. Teachers, in turn, are trying to make children and their parents the scapegoat. They seek to attribute children's poor learning to their parents' illiteracy and home environment. They fail to understand that children's absenteeism and poor performance are largely the result of what is happening in the classroom and the overall school functioning. The fact is that the larger percentage of dropout of children from schools is due to school-related reasons (59 per cent) as compared to family-related reasons (41 per cent).⁵

Learning support programs (LSPs) organized by the NGOs have succeeded in ensuring regular attendance of most children who have been absenting from the schools. Learning outcomes of children covered under LSPs have also improved substantially. This has been possible by changing the character of the classes that the children attend under LSPs. The classes were made child-friendly through innovative practices. The programs have broken the myth that children and their families are responsible for poor learning. They are forcing teachers to rethink their earlier position. Many teachers have shown interest in understanding the techniques used at the learning support programs.

Learning support programs organized by NGOs, specially AIF, have demonstrated that if the classrooms are organized creatively, the children who are at the verge of dropping out from school due to deficit in basic learning, can perform pretty well after going through the LSP courses. They are now regular at school and performing well in their classes. The classes were made child-friendly through innovative practices. The LSP intervention has broken the myth that children and their families are responsible for poor learning. These successes are forcing teachers to rethink their earlier position about children's absenteeism, lack of attention in the class and their poor learning levels. The success of the LSPs is also creating opportunity for working with government school teachers.

2.4 SCHOOLS UNABLE TO DEAL WITH FIRST-GENERATION LEARNERS

One of the important reasons for the dismal performance of the school system is its inability to deal with first-generation learners. The way our classrooms are organized, home support has become essential in children's learning. Parents who are illiterate are unable to provide this help to their children. Their poor financial situation prevents them from hiring private tutors. In addition, most of these children are irregular in school due to health, and socio-economic reasons further complicate the situation.

Our teachers find themselves ill-equipped to deal with these first-generation learners. The existing classroom organization and practices (textbook-centred teaching) also work against first-generation learners who require individualized attention, care and support. Schools need to reorient themselves to meet these requirements.

Many of the parents of these children are unable to provide the children with basic materials such as notebooks. While teachers need to be sensitized to the needs of first generation learners, parents also need to be made aware of the importance of sending children to school regularly and on time. They need to be explained the adverse impact that being irregular at school has. There is

⁵ Govinda, R. and Bandyopadhyay, M., (2011). Overcoming Exclusion through School Quality, CREATE Pathways to Access Research Monograph No 66, Delhi/Brighton: NUEPA/University of Sussex.



a great need to evolve social norms that encourage every child to attend school regularly and accord schooling priority over work and other household matters. Such norms can be established only by collective efforts.

3. PROSPECTS

3.1 THE RTE ACT, 2009 - AN OPPORTUNITY NOT TO BE WASTED

The Right to Education Act, 2009, a landmark legislation for ensuring children's right to free and compulsory elementary education, provides for necessary and improved infrastructure and trained and qualified teachers who are supposed to be recruited within a certain timeframe. It also seeks to include all out of school children in schools by providing them special training. The number of teachers required is to be calculated for each school as per the RTE norms. The idea is to weed out the chronic problems of teacher shortage and irrational deployment of teachers.

3.2 STRESS ON GOVERNANCE AND ACCOUNTABILITY IN THE ACT

The Act envisages decentralized planning and management of school education. It seeks to do this decentralization through allocation of various responsibilities to SMCs and Local Self-Government institutions. This is a key provision, which has the potential to go a long way in enhancing school efficiency. A decent school infrastructure and an adequate number of qualified



teachers are very important to a system overhaul, but these alone may not accomplish much unless school management is improved.

3.3 PARENTS AND TEACHERS AS KEY STAKEHOLDERS

The foundation stones of a school are an aware, organized and equipped community, a healthy teacher–community relationship, and a good teacher–child relationship. Facilitated by the provisions of the RTE Act, community and parents, as the most important stakeholders, can take initiatives and necessary steps to enable schools to function well. If one examines some of the well-performing government schools in various states of the country, even though small in number, one will find that the communities have active and effective engagement with these schools. Effective community engagement is the most crucial factor in schools performing well.

Under the RTE Act, 2009, parents have been entrusted with certain powers through the School Management Committee elected by them; proper exercise of the same can initiate a process of improving schools. For this to happen, the community at large and SMC members in particular have to be supported through training and handholding. They have to be made aware of the provisions of the RTE, as well as the roles, composition, and process of formation of SMCs. SMCs need to be equipped to discharge the responsibility envisaged in the RTE Act. In absence of the orientation and equipping of the SMC, the potential of the Act will remain without realization.

3.4 SMCs AND LSGs ARE IMPORTANT INSTRUMENTS FOR TRANSFORMING SCHOOLS

The provision for decentralized planning and management by the SMC and the local authority is the most promising aspect of the RTE Act. Its implementation, however, is a big challenge, especially given the fact that the overarching trend in governance is towards centralization. Nevertheless, the key to school reform lies in the provision of assigning the planning and management roles to the local community.

The roles and responsibilities vested in the SMCs and LSGs provide opportunity to the local community to intervene in the schooling process and bring about improvement in the functioning of schools. By improving the school functioning and overall accountability in the system, SMCs can help actualize the true purpose of the RTE legislation. Individuals and organizations working at the grassroots level ought to mobilize SMCs and LSGs along with the larger community, and further ascertain that the critical provisions of the RTE legislation are implemented in their true spirit and not remain solely on paper. In absence of an active civil society support to this Act, there is every possibility that this might also not see the light of day, a similar fate to several other progressive legislations of the past.⁶

There are numerous examples within the country of organized and active communities taking charge of their local schools, thereby effecting substantial improvement in their functioning. The communities, with the support of civil society organizations, have been able to reverse the continuing downslide of the schools—first by establishing a positive relationship with the schools, and then turning around the cynical outlook, replacing it with enthusiasm and energy, particularly among the teachers in the schools.

4. BRIEF REVIEW OF SCHOOL REFORMS EFFORTS IN INDIA

It will be important to take stock of schemes such as District Primary Education Programme (DPEP) and Sarva Shiksha Abhiyan (SSA) to draw relevant lessons for improving the quality of schooling in our country, as decentralized planning and management of schools was an important theme of these Schemes. An assessment of the key achievements and failures of these efforts follows.

4.1 KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

The efforts so far have led to a very significant expansion of the schooling infrastructure. However, there is still a shortfall on many counts, such as a classroom for every teacher, separate and functional toilets for boys and girls, grounds and equipments for sports, and over all upgradation of the physical environment. The RTE Act provides for these infrastructural improvements.

While physical access to schooling has improved tremendously, the fact that in remote areas single teacher, buildingless schools still abound, remains a major cause for concern. The teachers in many schools, more so in backward states, are untrained or semi-trained, with most of them working on contract and earning meagre salaries. The RTE Act specifies a minimum of two trained teachers for every school. The service conditions of the teachers are supposed to meet certain prescribed standards. Ensuring these specific provisions is going to be one of the key challenges ahead.

4.2 KEY CHALLENGES

Programs such as DPEP and SSA have also created a heavy demand of information supply on schools. Different types of data needs to be generated in schools on a periodic basis. Apart from

⁶ There are many pro-people legislations in India which are yet to be implemented in reality. These have remained on paper, with common people finding it almost impossible to seek benefit from these legislations given the nature and character of the bureaucracy.

this regular collection and supply of data very often schools have to meet random demands for sending information. Teachers remain engaged in collecting, collating and supplying information to their superiors. In the absence of a culture of systematic maintenance of records, this task tends to heavily impede upon the instruction time of the teachers.

The school system, like many systems within the government, has spiralled downward into the culture of non-accountability, leading to extremely poor performance. Over the years, centralization efforts in many areas of schooling, mainly in the name of ensuring quality, have resulted in the burial of local accountability mechanism. Absence of reward and punishment in the system has also led to lack of accountability and a consistently lackadaisical attitude.

The near complete absence of opportunities for upward mobility of teachers or defined career paths, also contributes to a lack of motivation among them. They live by the adage of **'once a teacher, always a teacher'**.

Teacher Training Institutions are in need of a major restructuring. The curriculum of pre-service and in-service training need updation and reorientation, specifically keeping in view the needs of first generation learners, the fact that almost all children join grade one without any experience of pre-primary education and the need for incorporating current researches on early reading, amongst other things.

4.3 DPEP AND SSA

Programs such as DPEP and SSA focused on universalizing elementary education since their inception. They made notable progress in creating school infrastructure, providing teachers, renewing textbooks, and creating academic support structures at the school cluster level. However, all this could not translate into improved quality of learning imparted in schools. Moreover, huge attrition between Classes I–X continued to plague the system.

The DPEP also sought to decentralize educational planning to the district level in order to respond to the diverse needs within each state. Most districts, though, lacked the required capacities (for instance, vision, strategic thinking, data handling, planning, management), which became a hindrance in the way of their taking a lead in planning.

Besides, there were many interventions which required close attention and sensitive handling at the ground level, such as running residential bridge courses for out of school children, and specific interventions for street and working children, children living in areas affected by armed conflict, children of sex workers, and other 'difficult to reach' categories. These programs needed collaborative efforts with civil society organizations. Bureaucratic structures are not geared to handle such programs which require sensitive handling and an innovative and flexible framework. Both DPEP and SSA have been weak on counts of evolving genuine partnership models for civil society engagements in such activities.

DPEP had covered only selected districts, but SSA was launched to cover all districts of the country. SSA also addressed mainstream institutions like SCERTs and DIETs which were not the focus in DPEP. The situation, though, did not improve much with SSA either, and the key issues existing prior to DPEP's launch still haunt the school system.

RTE now presents a new constitutionally mandated opportunity to restore the school system



to health, and the differentiating factor in this legislation is the very important component of enabling communities and using strengthened community institutions to improve schools. This potential remained largely untapped in the pre-RTE period.

4.3.1 TWIN CHALLENGES OF GOVERNANCE AND PEDAGOGY

A careful analysis of the public school system in India brings to the fore the twin challenges it faces — failed governance and archaic pedagogic practices. Various programs and organizations have attempted pedagogic renewal in the past few decades. These efforts have failed to attain the desired result in the absence of efforts to improve the governance of schools. The public school system remains highly centralized and has almost no accountability towards its users or beneficiaries.⁷

There have been efforts to decentralize management of schools and bring about change in the accountability framework of the school system during the past two–three decades, but without much success. The Seventy-third and Seventy-fourth Constitutional Amendments, pertaining to PRIs and the RTE Act, 2009, where planning and management responsibilities have been vested in School Management Committees (SMCs) that consist primarily of the parents of school children, are efforts towards decentralizing planning and management within the school system. The meagre provisions made for capacity building of the SMCs and PRIs, though, along with



the fact that the entire task of capacity building has been left with the education bureaucracy, which lacks both the will and the expertise, will make sure that these institutions fail in getting strengthened.

The RTE Act provides a constitutionally mandated space for civil society organizations to work with community institutions like SMC and Panchayats, and help restore the community's role in planning and management of schools. The Committee headed by the former Education Secretary, Anil Bordia, which worked towards synchronization of SSA with RTE, has made very clear recommendations for civil society engagement. It has clearly identified areas where civil society ought to engage to support the implementation of RTE. Training and mentoring of SMCs is one of the key areas identified in the report. The Ministry of Human Resource Development needs to encourage states to step up the process of creating mechanisms and a facilitative environment for civil society engagement. A genuine partnership model is required whereby both sides have clearly laid down responsibilities as well as accountabilities. The current terms of engagement are extremely bureaucratic and more in the nature of subcontracting work to civil society organizations (CSO) rather than a genuine partnership based on the complementarity of both partners. Coupled with efforts towards improving governance of schools, pedagogic renewal efforts also need to be initiated. But this pedagogic renewal efforts should again not be with a 'top-down', 'one size fits all' approach.

7 Local communities lost control over their schools in the 1970s when schools were nationalized / provincialized. Most schools in the country till the 1970s were set up due to community initiatives. Even during British rule, powers to open schools, appoint, and transfer teachers were vested with the district administration.

4.3.2 CONCURRENT LIST STATUS OF EDUCATION AND CENTRALLY SPONSORED SCHEMES

Education was a state subject until 1974. After bringing education in the concurrent list of the Constitution, several centrally sponsored schemes were launched by the Union Government to improve school education and achieve Universalisation of Elementary Education (UEE). In spite of the several CSSs, poor quality of learning and the huge school dropout continue to remain critical areas of concern even today.

The Centrally Sponsored Scheme framework under which most central programs have been initiated suffers from serious lacuna. This approach of the Central Government has undermined states' initiative in Education. The focus of the states, very often, has been to draw the maximum amount of money they can from the Centre, showing high expenditure so that they may be able to draw even more money next year. Very often, activities have been carried out without due diligence vis-à-vis the basic preparation required and setting in place the basic processes. Disbursal of fund in absence of adequate capacity to implement the programs has, in many cases, led to wasteful expenditures and leakages.

Most inputs seem to be going waste without any tangible outcome. It is common knowledge that 'rent seeking' has become widespread within the various organs of the education system and this is responsible for a serious derangement of the system. Still, not enough attention has been paid to assessing the suitability of interventions under CSSs.

4.3.3 TOP-DOWN GENERIC APPROACHES FAILED TO DELIVER

All top-down interventions, such as teacher training and curriculum and textbook renewal, have failed to deliver. The needs and requirements at the ground level in a vast country like India are extremely diverse, and a contextualized, nuanced approach will be required to address the same. There is a possibility to arrive at a generic and flexible framework, which incorporates an overall direction of implementation from the central level, but allows for creation of specific interventions as per needs at the ground level. The thinking that each and every situation can be visualized at the top and all activities can be detailed at the central level can prove seriously counterproductive. The 'one-size-fits-all' approach has never worked in the area of education.

Centralized trainings have also been a bane of the education system. Teachers have developed training fatigue because trainings are generic in nature and not of much practical use to them. Teachers are not seeking any of these inputs, primarily as these are not based on any systematic assessment of training needs of the teachers. Thereby, we often witness these inputs going waste. The big question which needs to be answered is why are we in this situation, in spite of the many schemes having been in existence for so many years? This question is important also because the RTE Act provides us an opportunity to look beyond the existing frameworks. Elementary education having been made a fundamental, inalienable, right for every child in the country, necessitates transcending boundaries. Excuses such as a paucity of resources and capacities are no longer acceptable. It is important that we do not commit the same errors again.

5. IMPLEMENTATION OF THE RTE ACT: 2009–2012 — THE TREND SO FAR

The first two years of RTE Act's implementation have shown that until now the education bureaucracy has not seen it to be anything more than a mere extension of the SSA program, with a few better provisions. This attitude has several lacunae.

First, the fact that the Act makes elementary education a fundamental right of every child in the country is not being appreciated fully. Second, within the education bureaucracy, seriousness about meeting key milestones of the Act does not get clearly reflected. Third, the important roles assigned to the parents and the local self government in planning and management of schools are not being recognized and given the attention they deserve.

There has been an attempt to shift the timelines for meeting certain targets. It is evident that the basic targets of ensuring universal access, enrollment and basic infrastructure, by March 2013, is unlikely to happen. The Centre and the states will try passing the buck for the failure to meet major milestones outlined in the Act, taking refuge behind the education being on the concurrent list,⁸ which envisages shared responsibilities for states and the centre.

The way SMCs were constituted after the RTE Act came into force, without proper preparation, and the way School Development Planning exercise by the SMC has been neglected by the governments at both levels, reflects a non-serious attitude towards the move to decentralize education governance. The roles assigned to SMCs and local authorities constitute the most important provisions in the Act towards governance reform. Even today, there are no clear guidelines on accountability and grievance redressal within the education structure.

This rare opportunity cannot be allowed to go waste due to the indifference and callousness of the educational bureaucracy. This issue needs to be addressed on priority by civil society organizations. For decentralized governance and decentralized planning and implementation, as envisaged under the RTE Act, to become a reality serious efforts have to be made. The existing capacity of decentralized bodies and community institutions has to be assessed. Subsequently, adequate steps have to be taken to enhance their capacity by evolving appropriate tools and mechanisms for their engagement with schools and the education governance system.

We need to recognize that in absence of people's mobilization and the capacity building of local community and institutions, the RTE Act stands to lose significant power.

6. PEOPLE BECOME PART OF THE CHANGE

6.1 WHO TAKES INITIATIVE FOR CHANGE?

The school has to be viewed as a social organization, organically linked to the community. The community must have an effective say in the management of the school. Both teachers and the community have to initiate this process at the local level. Additionally, all local efforts have to converge to create a larger impact. We need a platform/forum to support and organize this process at a large level.

⁸ Education is in the concurrent list, wherein the Union government and the state governments have shared responsibilities.

As a matter of priority, the essential components of a good school need to be understood, especially by the parents. Some crucial issues they need to understand are child learning processes, teacher–child relationships, role of the school management, issues that schools face, and the role of an SMC in taking schools out of their present mess.

Parents will also need skills to engage with individual schools and also with the school system. These skills can be imparted through sustained support and handholding instead of sporadic training sessions. A sustained dialogue that facilitates parents' learning is required.

Engaging in a dialogue is a delicate and complex task. Mutual trust is a prerequisite for dialogue between the parties concerned. Those who engage with the community must have faith in its abilities. Very often it is seen that this trust and belief is missing among the development professionals/managers and field functionaries, in absence of which they bypass the participatory processes and take recourse to instruction. In absence of the participatory processes, the entire exercise of local planning becomes meaningless.

The managers of the programs do not seriously attempt to build capacity of the community, as they do not believe that the community is capable of delivering what has been expected of them, nor do they think that community intervention can really make an efficacious difference to the system.

LAMP - LEARNING ENRICHMENT PROGRAM

ध्रुवतारा

गणित वर्कबुक 1





CHAPTER TWO: PERSPECTIVE ON DECENTRALISATION

1. UNDERSTANDING THE POLITICS OF DECENTRALIZATION

The decentralization discourse in development is more than five decades old. It has been part of most discussions on political, social and economic reforms across platforms, countries and continents. Decentralization is often considered essential to **democratization, cultural and indigenous rights, local accountability, and local governance.**

Similarly, decentralization of education is an accepted global phenomenon, and has been attempted for myriad reasons. Researchers, though, differ in their views about the desirability of decentralization in education. Many are of the view that decentralization often does not result in improving the quality or in reaching more numbers, while others argue that this is absolutely essential in increasing democratic processes. While there are examples of some highly centralized education systems achieving results, there are also instance of some that do not. By the same token, some decentralized systems achieve goals and some do not.



These mixed outcomes have raised certain questions about decentralization and have intensified debate on the elements and relationships (namely, conditions, legal frameworks, policies, leadership, capacities and practices) required for decentralization to achieve results in schools and other systems.

The key arguments in favor of decentralization are the following:

- It will strengthen democracy by transferring power from central to local bodies and by bringing the decision-making process closer to the people.
- It will strengthen the local culture and community. It will enable local schools to design programs and activities that cater to the needs of the local community, which will have a positive effect on students' motivation and learning.
- It achieves rationalization and efficiency. Underlying this argument is the belief that local authorities and schools are competent to use existing funds in a flexible and efficient way, and even obtain new local resources. Decentralization makes these schools more accountable and efficient.

Education decentralization policies are in force around the world. The objectives of such policies- especially those geared to increasing school autonomy and local governance-may include improving service delivery, but more commonly involve shifting political power or funding responsibilities.⁹

An increasing number of countries now follow a policy of decentralization in education, and, therefore, decisions on setting up new schools and their locations and teacher recruitment and deployment, previously taken at the central level, are now in the hands of actors at the district and local level. Actors at the local level have detailed knowledge of the characteristics and needs of the population they serve as well as of the education institutions in their area. They are, therefore, in a better position to define appropriate strategies to attract and retain disadvantaged groups in the education system. Local actors, however, need to acquire skills to plan for education within their area with three basic objectives: **equity, cost-efficiency, and quality.**

2. DECENTRALIZATION — AN IMPORTANT OPPORTUNITY FOR CIVIL SOCIETY ORGANIZATIONS

Decentralization in the sphere of education can enable people to improve the quality of education. It provides space for the local community to participate actively in planning and management of education. It helps them to take charge of their situation instead of remaining help-less recipients. Civil Society Organizations have to recognize this space and use it for ensuring inclusive and people centric development.

Many Civil Society Organizations have been able to initiate a positive process of school improvement by mobilizing parents to take initiative to transform their schools through efforts like training, handholding, and creation of appropriate mechanisms for constructive engagement with schools. Communities' understanding about special position of teachers in the entire learning endeavor and their constraints has led them to build better relationship with teachers and work with them towards improving schools. A positive, healthy relationship amongst the community, teachers, and children can be witnessed in these schools. The realization that the community and teachers together have a role in changing schools has started seeping in.

In the absence of any positive guidance and mediation, community's involvement in schools has often led to a confrontation with the teachers. Communities feel teachers are primarily responsible for the poor state of affairs in schools. Teachers too have many apprehensions about communities, not all of them unfounded. An active effort is needed to break this negative spiral, for which CSOs can work as mediators between different stakeholders and specially between teachers and the community.

Learning Support Initiatives (LSI)¹⁰ for children coupled with awareness building efforts for community has helped both communities and teachers to shed their negative attitude towards each other. They have developed a better understanding and appreciation for the others' important role in improving school education. This has led to an improvement in enrollment, participation, retention and learning achievements.

Children's progress in learning under LSIs works as the biggest motivator for parents. Also, as witnessed by the teachers, the same children who had been doing poorly prior to the LSI have now started performing very well in the classroom, leading these teachers to shed some of their negative attitude towards the children and their parents. This significant change in children's learning progress and their active participation in the classroom has made teachers reflect on their negative view of these children, and realize that these so called poor performing children are like any other children. They do not have any lesser potential and are fully capable of achieving what other children can, and what is needed is a different treatment and

9 Various schemes under the EGS umbrella and Para-Teacher schemes are good examples of this.

10 LSI is designed to address basic learning deficit of children in Grades 3–5. It helps children acquire basic literacy and numeracy skills, while enabling them to become independent learners. It is a scientifically planned, tightly monitored 25-week program, conducted for 2-hours daily beyond school hours. Pilot interventions have shown 95 per cent success rate (evidence-based).



individualized attention. The innovative pedagogic package (learning material, teacher training and classroom organization) used in LSI can easily be transferred in government schools. Many teachers have shown interest in adopting this innovative practice in their classrooms and they are being offered training and support for the same.

While efforts are required on multiple fronts such as improving school infrastructure, building capacity of teachers, creating child-friendly schools and classrooms, overhauling the accountability structure, and others, but without influencing the overall systemic culture which has been discussed at length in earlier sections, none of these will really bear expected result and become sustainable.

Once the community understands the different interventions required to improve their schools and articulate them clearly, in a democratic system where political parties have to go to the people every five years for their support, it would be difficult for these parties to ignore these demands of an organized section of the society. It is this space which has to be used by pro-people organizations to benefit the vast masses.



CHAPTER THREE: SCHOOL MAPPING AND MICRO-PLANNING A TOOL FOR PARTICIPATORY PLANNING

1. SCHOOL MAPPING AND MICRO-PLANNING

School Mapping and Micro-Planning (SM&MP) is an effective tool for localized planning, implementation, and monitoring of school activities. The two components, namely School Mapping and Micro Planning, are interlinked and represent a set of tools for decentralized and participatory planning and monitoring of school education.

The principle of decentralized planning is founded on the realization that 'one size does not fit all'. It also recognizes the fact that universal principles may not be universally applicable in one form. There may be variations in its application, as per practical needs and requirements of the community, whereby these adaptations have to be incorporated by local communities.



2. EVOLUTION OF SCHOOL MAPPING & MICRO-PLANNING

School Mapping has been central to planning education facilities at the local level. France was the first to use School Mapping as a technique for deciding the most appropriate locations for schools when it made plans to have universal school education in the country. It was followed by many other countries in due course.

The concept of School Mapping has continued to evolve over the decades. In the current context, we are proposing the use of School Mapping and Micro-Planning **as a set of tools and processes** for participatory planning and monitoring of quality school education for all. The SM&MP exercises focus on planning for education of every individual child in a prescribed geography. The exercise also focuses on particular characteristics and needs of populations in specific areas and seek to ensure basic provisions of education services following the overall guidelines enunciated under the RTE Act, 2009 .

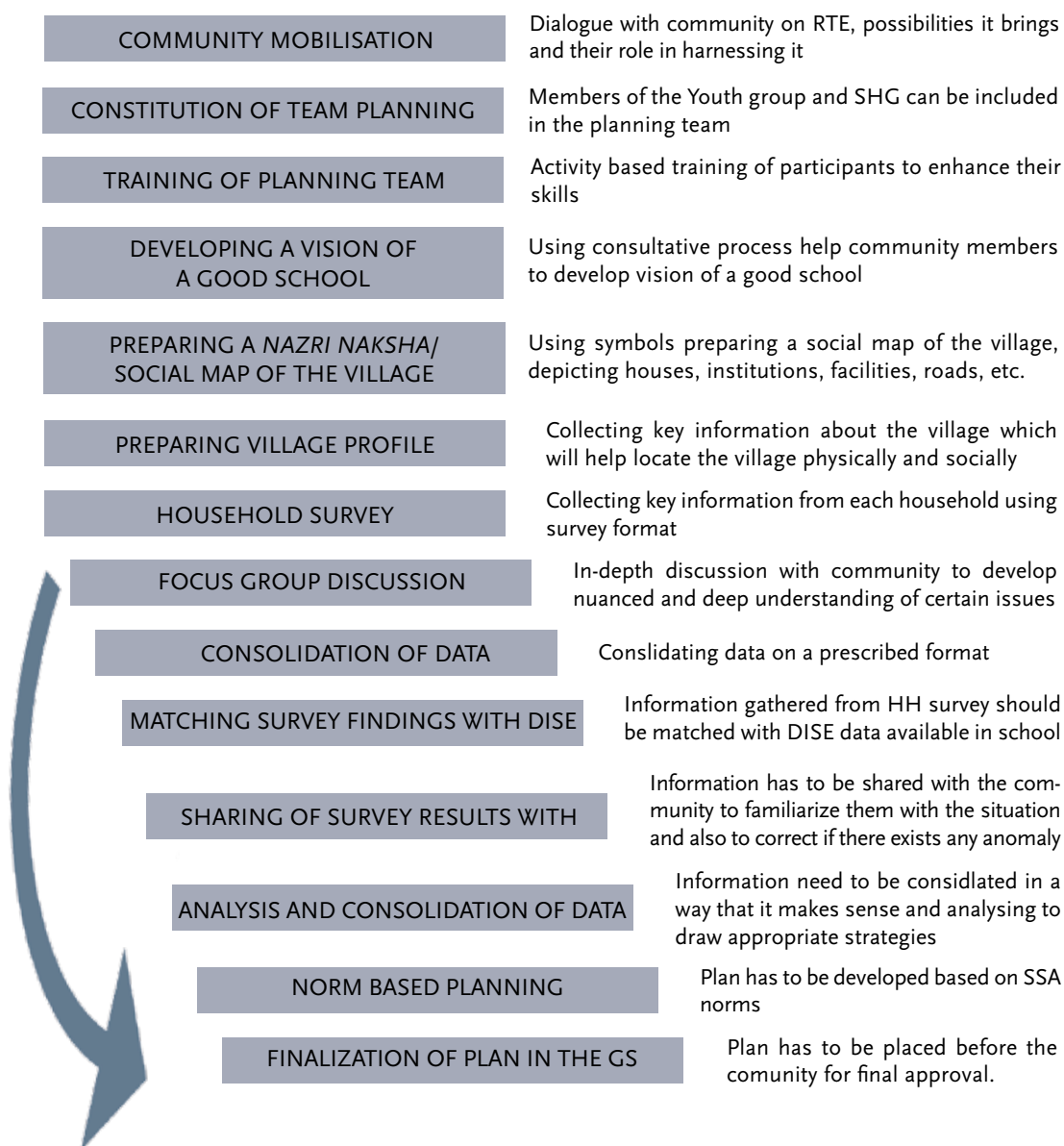
School Mapping and Micro-Planning also represent processes involving local and regional stakeholders in the implementation of national educational policies and plans at the local level, and reaching the educational development goals of the country as a whole. SM&MP thus constitute very important elements in achieving the UEE goals to which a country commits itself.

As a tool for participatory planning for UEE, Micro-Planning helps assess the educational status of every child in a habitation. It also provides an opportunity for the local community to reflect on issues impacting their children's education and find appropriate actionable strategies to ensure universal enrollment and quality learning. Participation of the community in the entire process makes them better aware of the educational issues and help them to act in an organized fashion to improve education.

3. SCHOOL MAPPING AND MICRO-PLANNING UNDER RTE

The RTE Act visualizes decentralization of planning and management of school education as an important step to ensure quality school education for all. It envisages a greater say for parents and the local community in the planning and managing of schools. The implementation guidelines of RTE recommend preparation of a School Development Plan by the SMC, using School Mapping and Micro Planning (SM&MP) exercise. The key steps of the SM&MP exercise are discussed below.

3.1 KEY STEPS IN SCHOOL MAPPING AND MICRO-PLANNING



4. COMMUNITY MOBILIZATION

Mobilizing community on the issue of education is an important step towards implementing the RTE. Initial mobilization, often termed Environment Building, is about preparing ground for positive community action. It is like preparing soil before sowing a seed. It is about preparing a conducive atmosphere for the implementation of any plan or activity. It can also be viewed as removing any resistance that may appear due to misunderstanding and apprehensions.

Using appropriate messages and media are important for mobilizing people. To do this, the key messages within the RTE will need to be identified and then communicated using various media. Folk media, such as songs, yatra, and street theatre, are effective instruments in spreading messages in societies with a strong oral tradition. Many of these media serve the twin purposes of entertainment and message delivery. While entertaining people during a program, utmost care should be taken to ensure that the message selected does not hurt the sentiments of anyone. Special efforts should be made to have women participate in the program. Certain values like gender and social equity have to be clearly adhered to in selecting messages and delivering them by the artists.

Local communities must be mobilized to share certain responsibilities in organizing these activities. In the process of organizing these activities persons who had shown initiatives and had taken responsibilities can become contact points for carrying out future activities and for continuing the dialogue process.

Community contribution in terms of time and resources are important aspects in mobilization. People's willingness to contribute time and money are also indicators of their support to the idea. Community mobilization in essence is a process of dialogue with and within the community, which helps the community to sharpen their understanding on specific issues.

As the famous education thinker Paulo Freire believed, dialogue isn't just about deepening understanding—but is part of making a difference in the world. Dialogue in itself is a cooperative activity involving respect. The process is important and can be seen as enhancing community awareness and building social capital and striving collectively towards developing a just and human society. Freire argued for **informed action by the community to change their destiny**.

During the community mobilization on RTE, the following issues need to get attention :

- Importance of education as an empowering tool to overcome deprivation and exclusion.
- Significance of the RTE Act, 2009.
- Key provisions of the RTE Act, 2009.
- The possibilities it raises.
- Communities' important role in achieving these possibilities by initiating reform.
- Important role played by parents and the community in the process of a child's learning and development.
- Developing an idea of what a good school should be.
- Understanding the condition of their village schools and the reasons for this condition.
- Planning to change the condition of the village schools.
- Issues of exclusion, including gender and social categories.



- Potential of children's education to create a win-win situation for the entire community and bridge the social divide.

Change is the key message, and the role of parents, the local community, and LSGs in bringing the change in education of their children needs to be deliberated. The fact that the people need to take charge of their children's education and are capable of doing so has to be emphasized. People should be familiarized about the SMC under RTE, its composition, roles, and responsibilities. Following this, the SMC should be formed by the *Gram Sabha*.

Community mobilization is a continuous process and not a one-time activity. A sustained dialogue that facilitates a community's learning and meaningful action is needed. In the whole process of community taking a centre stage in planning and management of education, the consultative process has to continue in a different form. Dialogue is a delicate and complex process. There is no dialogue possible without mutual trust. Very often this trust is missing. Paulo Freire observed that 'most development facilitators lack this confidence in communities' abilities and resort to bypassing the participatory processes'. 'Dialogue,' he stated, 'involves respect. It should not involve one person acting on another, but rather people working with each other'.

5. ISSUES THAT REQUIRE SPECIAL EMPHASIS

5.1 IMPORTANT ROLE OF THE COMMUNITY

Currently, school is viewed as an alien institution, owned by the government, with the common people/parents having very little or no say in its working. This perception needs to be corrected. School should be viewed as one of the most important institutions of society. School and society have to be organically linked since both play important roles in the development of the child. Community members will be able to support schools and play a catalytic role in improving the education of their children if they are sensitized about the following:

- The RTE Act's implementation requires a comprehensive understanding of the school system and the reasons for its inefficiency.
- SMC members' (and parents) unique position to initiate a turnaround in the current situation.
- They will be able to fulfil this historic role only by equipping themselves with a sound knowledge of governance. It is imperative to act or intervene from an organized authoritative position. The rules of the game have to be understood to play the game well.
- They must know about the system of governance of public education— how schools should function, how education in the schools should be organized, the source and amount of funding, who is responsible for what, and so on.
- They must also know about the learning processes and the relationship between school and society. They also need to know the role a teacher plays in the learning process, how the teacher's attitude impacts the learning of the child, as well as her overall development, amongst other things.
- They need to be aware that public money, that is the taxpayers money, is used for developing public services, which includes schools. The community is justified in demanding optimal use of the resources for their maximum good and public institutions' accountability towards the local community they serve.

5.2 FORMATION OF THE PLANNING TEAM

The second important step in the process of SM&MP is the formation of the planning team (PT), consisting of members from the SMC and some members from the youth and adolescent groups. Some retired teacher or ex-servicemen of the village can also be included if they are interested. Care should be taken to ensure the participation of women and other deprived groups in the team without compromising on their competence in terms of the tasks involved in the planning exercise. The planning team can be treated as a planning sub-committee of the SMC, having five–seven members who are accountable to the SMC.

5.3 TRAINING THE PLANNING TEAM

Training of the PT is a critical task in the SM&MP exercise, which can have two main components. The first component seeks to develop the team's understanding of the key aspects of planning, while the second part can be a practical exercise that includes activities like household survey, school data analysis, Focus Group Discussion (FGD), consolidation of data, and plan formulation. The entire training would last approximately five days. Two days can be devoted to discussion on key aspects of planning, followed by field work comprising data collection, and finally, consolidation and analysis of data and preparation of the School Development Plan.

The intention of creating a School Development Plan is to foster a process of school-based planning and shared decision-making, involving parents, teachers, and local self-government representatives to improve the efficiency of schools, or more precisely the educational performance of all students.

5.3.1 SOME KEY ASPECTS TO BE COVERED IN THE TRAINING

The following issues need to be covered while training SMC members:

- Key provisions of the RTE Act, 2009.
- Roles of the SMC and the opportunity parents have to improve their schools' working.
- Role of parents in the School Management Committee.
- Preparing a School Development Plan, generating information using school records, undertaking School Mapping, organizing Focus Group Discussion (FGD) etc.
- Role of the SMC in financial management.
- The current situation and system of the school in terms of student enrollment, participation, retention, promotion, and learning achievement.
- Relationship between the teacher and the community.
- Relationship of the SMC with the local authority.
- Creating an educational data base and a monitoring tool.
- Sensitizing them with the Child Rights issues.

5.4 DEVELOPING A VISION OF A GOOD SCHOOL

School vision exercise is an extremely important step towards improving schools and ensuring the implementation of the RTE Act in its true spirit. Without a vision, your school lacks direction. A vision is an image of a desired future—a picture of the future you seek to create. It shows where you want to go and what it will be like when you get there. It is worth describing your ideal school as if it already exists.

If the community and teachers don't have a common, agreed-on destination, then everyone is left to his or her own devices to imagine one—a scenario that results in unharnessed and unfocused efforts, with everyone believing that what he or she is doing is right. A common understanding of the destination allows all stakeholders to align their improvement efforts. The best part of planning for this journey is that it doesn't cost anything to decide where you want to go. Vision development exercise is a complex exercise and has to be facilitated carefully. There are some key steps of this exercise.

5.4.1 ASSESSING THE CURRENT PERCEPTION

First, we must assess what is the current vision for the school in the community. Through a participatory process, the facilitator can capture the broad vision the community, teachers, and children have about **the school they know** and **the school they want**.

This exercise must cover various aspects of school life, such as infrastructure, school environment, teacher–child relationship, learning outcomes, and the overall purpose of education.

5.4.2 SHARING SOME OTHER VISIONS

Having gathered the existing vision, the facilitator should share some of the visions that other communities have about their schools. This can be done using some good audio-visual materials, wherever possible. Sharing videos of some good schools, including school processes and stakeholders' expectations from the school will be beneficial. A discussion around what is viewed may help the community build its vision.

5.4.3 DEVELOPING A SHARED VISION

Based on the exposure and discussion, the community may be asked to restate its overall vision, as well as its vision about various aspects of schooling. **The only meaningful way to develop a vision owned by all is to develop a process that involves everyone.**¹¹ Such a process will help develop their ideal school that reflects the 'best' thinking, beliefs, and ideals of the entire community. Tension between the vision and the reality is a source of creativity and professional development, but if the vision is powerful enough it will provide the rationale for all decision making.

6. PREPARING PROFILE OF THE VILLAGE

Preparing a profile of the village involves listing some key information about the village. A village profile must mention all resources, especially human resources, available in the village. It should list the availability of retired teachers, ex-servicemen, graduates, and other skilled people whose skills can be used in a variety of activities for improving the educational level of the village children. People with skills in Computers, English and Mathematics, teaching, story telling, carpentry, pottery, theatre, and other relevant skills should be identified. This information can help plan realistic and implementable activities. For example, if one plans to operate computer classes, availability of electricity and persons having relevant computer skills are two crucial information which will help us in developing a realistic and implementable plan.

7. PREPARING A NAZARI NAKSHA OF A VILLAGE

This is a participatory tool for assessing educational and other facilities in a village. Since sym-

11 Developing a powerful school vision, available at <http://www.leading-learning.co.nz/index.html>



bols are used in describing/depicting a facility or information, it is possible for even an illiterate person to use this as an assessment tool. *Nazari Naksha* (NN) is also a graphical/pictorial presentation of the educational scenario in the village, which helps generate a dialogue among the stakeholders, including members of the community.

It can involve two stages, the first stage leading to the creation of a preliminary map and the second stage devoted to creating the final map. The steps can be as follows:

- One end of the village from where the survey will begin will need to be identified.
- Using color pencils, main roads within the village will be marked.
- 'Compass rows' should be drawn showing the four directions.
- Different institutions and facilities in the village will be plotted on the map, using appropriate symbols
- Thereafter, houses will be marked on the map in sequence without missing a single house.
- Migrant households can be marked separately.
- Educational status of children (boys and girls separately) such as enrolled, never-enrolled, drop-out, etc. will be marked within each household.

It is important that we involve community members in this mapping. After discussions with the



community, the map may be finalized and drawn on a fresh chart, mentioning the name of the village and the date on which the NN was prepared.

As far as possible, standardized symbols need to be used during the mapping exercise to represent/depict various facilities/information in the village.

8. HOUSEHOLD SURVEY

The purpose of a household (HH) survey is to find out the actual educational status of every child in a village by visiting the family. This is also an opportunity to connect with the parents of children and ascertain their views on their children's education and the status of education in the village.

For the purpose of SM&MP, habitations, and not the revenue village, should be considered for assessing the access situation (availability of school within approachable distance). For SDP purposes, all habitations that fall in the catchment area of the school need to be covered. Catchment area of a school is defined by the educational administration.

Before starting a survey, each household has to be given a definite number to ensure none is

excluded from the survey. The survey has to be performed using a prescribed format. The entire team may split into two or three groups to complete the process fast. Information has to be collected using the prescribed survey format.

8.1 MAIN STEPS OF THE SURVEY

- The team must collectively study and understand the survey formats.
- It should survey some households together before splitting into groups.
- It should number each household by using census or other numbers.
- It should collect HH survey data on a prescribed format.

9. SCHOOL SURVEY/ASSESSMENT

The school survey will assess infrastructure, availability of teachers, training needs of teachers, student enrollment status, retention, promotion, and learning achievements of children. District Information System for Information (DISE) data can be an important source of information. SMC members and teachers can undertake this assessment exercise together.

10. COMPARING DISE DATA WITH HH SURVEY DATA

The next important step is to compare the results of the HH data with DISE records. This is a very important step and requires careful handling. Due to various external and internal reasons, school record data is unreliable. It is common knowledge that the Mid-Day Meal Scheme has led to inflation in attendance figures in schools.

It is also widely known that very often, the names of children who have dropped out of schools continue to appear in the school register. While tallying two sources of data, one might come across a mismatch, where rectifying this may be resisted by the teachers and also other functionaries of the school administration. The school administration is still in denial mode about the large number of children remaining out of school, poor participation of children and the poor learning achievement. This correction is extremely important. If we do not accept the real figure of children who are out of school, we will not plan for their inclusion.

Similarly, data related to teachers and others has to be verified and, if required, corrected. This exercise will also provide an opportunity for community to better know the situation of their school and also bring transparency in the reported data under DISE. If verification of information starts at the school level by the local community, this will ensure that there is no over-reporting or under-reporting. This exercise turns into a sort of social audit of the data. It is also a known fact that the one certain way to bring authenticity in data recording is to ensure use of data by those who collect it.

Most often, data is inaccurate because it is meant for the use of others who are far removed from the local situation and they, therefore, may not care enough for the authenticity of the data. Local use of data is the most effective remedy for sanitizing data. If this exercise is undertaken in all schools and villages, individual teachers will not feel threatened.

11. COMPILING DATA BY USING APPROPRIATE FORMATS AND ANALYSIS AFTER VERIFICATION

After crosschecking/tallying the data collected on enrollment, retention, and dropouts with the school records and records of AWCs, the same may be recorded on a pre-designed consolidation sheet. The format of a consolidation sheet is given in the Annexure.

For data to be used for planning, it has to be compiled in appropriate formats. Formats are generated keeping in mind the possible strategies and also to capture details about different categories of beneficiaries for whom interventions need to be planned. Planning team members have to be provided predesigned formats for both data collection and compilation. If computers and people skilled in using software such as Excel are available, the compilation exercise can be faster and more accurate.

12. DIAGNOSIS

In the context of educational planning, diagnosis means making a fair assessment of achievements and constraints. Let us illustrate this with an example of the issue of children dropping out of a school. Diagnosis for the dropout problem will list the children who are dropping out and their social and economic background. It will list their gender and see whether the maximum dropout occurs in particular grades or a particular month/period.

After collecting information on all this from the school or village records, one needs to diagnose the reason behind dropping out. A diagnosis of the issue can be attempted based on impressions/opinions of the various stakeholders, especially parents, the community, children, and the teachers. One will need to examine whether the stakeholders' perceptions differ. While opinions and perceptions of the stakeholders are important since they provide valuable insights into the problem, an accurate/objective diagnosis will require triangulation of these perceptions/opinions. Looking at relevant researches will be an important step in enriching the diagnosis.

One might find the factors responsible for the dropping out of children are multiple, such as shortage of teachers, poor school infrastructure (lack of toilets, classroom), teachers' attitude, incomprehension in the classroom arising out of absence of basic literacy and numeracy skills in children, and some family-related reasons as well.

13. FOCUS GROUP DISCUSSION (FGD)

To develop a deeper understanding of certain problems identified during HH survey and community interactions, an FGD is organized. For example, an FGD could be held to understand the reasons for low attendance of a particular group of children, low enrollment of girls, or student dropout occurring in particular grades or a particular period of the year, and others. The purpose of focused group discussions is to gain knowledge about a particular topic or need by interviewing a group of people directly affected by the issue.

Focus groups are appropriate when you want to explore the depth and nuances of opinions regarding an issue, understand what factors influence opinions or behavior, or test reactions to actual or proposed services.

They are not appropriate when you need to ask participants sensitive information, statistical in-

formation about an entire population, or when you are working with an emotionally or politically charged group.

It is important to choose or set up a physical space for the focus group, where they feel welcome and comfortable. The space should be neutral, private, free from distractions, and easily accessible.

It is important to convey to participants that their opinions are valued, that they are the experts, and that the focus group facilitator and other staff have come to learn from them. This empowers participants, helps them have a sense of purpose, and helps eliminate any barriers that may arise as a result of differences between participants and focus group staff.

The role of the facilitator is important in a focus group discussion. Information generated through an FGD can be useful for planning suitable interventions.

14. DISCUSSING POSSIBLE STRATEGIES FOR ACHIEVING UEE

Based on a diagnosis, an appropriate strategy following SSA guidelines and norms needs to be identified. If the community feels that certain interventions need to be included which do not find place in the SSA norms, it may do so but such activities may not be funded under SSA. Other sources of resource mobilization such as the PRI fund, the MLA fund, and the MPLAD fund should be explored. Some states have funds for special schemes, such as a Drought Relief Fund, a Border Area Development Fund, etc., which can also be tapped. Community contribution can be a very important source of funds. Funds can also be accessed through convergence with other schemes.

Interventions identified must focus on key aspects like ensuring access, enrollment, retention and quality learning for all children in the eligible age group.

15. FINALIZING INTERVENTIONS IN CONSULTATION WITH THE COMMUNITY

After interventions are identified, these should be placed before the larger community for discussion. A genuine effort should be made to have the community agree with and affirm the proposed interventions. Community members would contribute in sharpening the focus of the plan using their experiences. The community members will also have suggestion about implementation of the plan and for mobilizing resources. Community involvement in finalizing plan activities will help ensuring community support in implementation of these activities too.

16. PREPARING A THREE-YEAR WORKPLAN AND AN ANNUAL WORKPLAN

Taking into account the major milestones of the RTE Act, the Act proposes a three-year workplan alongwith an Annual Work Plan. There is a definite time frame (a three year period) for ensuring Universal Access, Universal Coverage, School Infrastructures, Teacher availability as per the prescribed Pupil teacher Ratio(PTR), and others. SMCs need to make a three year plan along with the annual work plan for the next year.

Plan must include key interventions vis-à-vis various aspects of the UEE (specified in the key

components of the plan) and assessment of financial as well as non-financial resources required for each of these interventions/activities and also a time frame for implementation.

Contributions made by the community has to be separated from government contribution. There are likely to be many activities in the plan which can be met from the local resources and many activities may not require government funding. For example, in many schools, children are not punctual. To ensure timely attendance, the community may decide that the school ring the bell 15 minutes prior to starting the school or it may involve school children to go house to house to mobilize children to come to school on time. There can be many other activities to improve attendance, the quality of MDM, overall school environment, and others, which the community can manage even without government aid. The general tendency is to list only those items in the plan for which the SMC requires funds from the government.

The SMC may decide on certain activities for which there is no financial provision within the SSA. Lack of financial allocation should not restrict the community from planning these activities. Apart from community contributions, funds can be accessed from other sources, like local pan-chayats, MLAs, the MPLAD fund and also from individual philanthropists and others.

It is important that the community develops a vision of the school that it wants for its children and plans towards actualizing that vision over a definite period of time.



CHAPTER FOUR: PREPARING SCHOOL DEVELOPMENT PLAN

1. SCHOOL DEVELOPMENT PLAN

The School Development Plan (SDP) is the soul of the transformation sought under the RTE. It needs to be prepared thoughtfully, having practical solutions to all questions raised at the time of comparing the existing situation with the desired situation of the school. The circumstances and needs of the village community must be reflected clearly in the SDP. The SDP should not be regarded merely as a budget proposal. Its focus should be on key transformative issues, such as acquiring adequate teachers, improving school functioning, children's learning, school infrastructure and overall school environment, the appointment of female teachers in schools, and so on. The measures to make the school a place where the child experiences 'growth' should be stated in the plan. An easy test while making a decision/demand is asking—'Does the child benefit from this? In what ways does it benefit her? What can be changed to improve things for her?' The issues emerging from the school vision exercise and the provisions under the RTE form the main basis for formulating the SDP.



Some of the important issues to be kept in mind while formulating SDP:

General Guidelines

- There should be an SDP for each school. If a village has three schools, three plans must be prepared.
- The SDP will be prepared by a sub-committee of the School Management Committee (SMC). Help/guidance from other sources may be taken. The community should be involved in data collection and verification tasks.
- A three-year plan along with a detailed annual work plan should be prepared.
- After being prepared, it should be presented in the Gram Sabha with an invitation to the community to suggest any possible changes.
- The plan should be sent to the designated authority, as prescribed by the state authority, through proper channels well in advance to get included in cluster, block and finally the district plans, before it is submitted to the Ministry of Human Resource Development, Government of India. For example, for the year beginning April 2011, the Plan should be ready by December, 2010.
- The plan must have components which may not require funds, and activities that can be completed with community help should be listed.

2. FORMULATING SCHOOL DEVELOPMENT PLAN

Most components* (mentioned under the next heading) would pass through the following stages:

- A. Assess the current situation
- B. Verify and analyze findings
- C. Look for solutions that best fit the ground realities
- D. Include them in the plan. These may be financial, social, economic.
- E. The plan must be guided by the community's vision about the school and it must base itself on the norms specified in the RTE Act, 2009.
- F. Various aspects of ensuring Universal Elementary Education must get included in the SDP.

The scope of the RTE Act, 2009 is vast. The issues mentioned below must find a place in an SDP:

- Universal Access.
- Universal Coverage.
- Physical infrastructure of the school.
- School environment — both physical and academic.
- Teachers requirement, assesment of training needs, plan for their training and other capacity enhancement measures.
- Universal participation, retention, and promotion.
- Quality of learning outcomes — fixing a minimum acceptable level of learning, doing baseline of the students' learning, planning for deficit filling in learning if required, learning support interventions for weaker children, etc.
- Avalability of Textbooks, learning material, and school library .
- Status of implementation of incentives such as MDM, School Uniform, stipend, etc., and the plan for improving these if needed.
- School sports, music, and arts.
- School health intervention.
- Budget.
- Implementation plan and the timeline with major milestones.

2.1 UNIVERSAL ACCESS

Definition: A primary school should be available for every habitation within a walkable distance of 1 km, and an Upper primary school within 3 kms.

This has more to do with the location of a school. The approach to school should be such that it is not affected by extreme weather conditions. Therefore, if the monsoon causes the seasonal river to flood making the school inaccessible for children, a new school may be planned for the children.

Things To Do

- Find out if there is a school in the village that can be reached by children of the village which are falling in the catchment area of the school, as defined by local authority.
- If there is a school, is it within walking distance, that is, 1 km for Primary or 3 kms for Upper Primary, as the case may be?
- Can this school be accessed by children from all sections of the community?
- If you come across issues hindering children accessing the school, what are these issues?
- If you are planning for a new school, discuss where should it be located?
- Keep in mind that there is enough land to have a playground, other necessary facilities, and it is safe for the children. The nearest available school should be clearly mentioned in the proposal.

- If the (small) size of the population or geographical conditions do not permit a request for a school, some alternative must be suggested. For example, a regular transport arrangement to the nearest school or a hostel attached to the nearest suitable school.

2.2 UNIVERSAL COVERAGE

Definition: No child of 6–14 years age should remain out of school for any reason. All children in the eligible age group must be in school.

The reasons which force a child to drop out from school, whether those are within the school (like unfriendly attitude of teachers, fear of punishment, non-comprehension due to basic learning deficit) or those outside the school (socio-economic reasons like, a girl-child having to fetch water for the family from a distant source, or remains preoccupied with taking care of younger siblings) must be listed and analyzed so that solutions are found for getting the child back into school.

Things To Do

- A door-to-door count to find out the number of children out of school, and to find whether they are dropouts or have never been enrolled.
- Cross-check the numbers with other sources like DISE.
- Establish the age of these children. Those in the 11–14 years group will need quick remedies as they will be shortly crossing the school-age and it may not be wise to mix them up with very young children for pedagogic and other reasons.
- Find out how long they have been out of school. If a child has been out for a long time, say three years or more, s/he may have to go through a bridging program to bring her/him on par with other schoolchildren in a short time.
- Ascertain why children opt out of school. What takes them away from school? What their motivation and aspirations are at their prime? Is it a fear of some kind, dismay at the proceedings in class? The reasons which keep them out will show the way for what must be included in the plan.

2.3 PHYSICAL INFRASTRUCTURE

Definition: All physical resources that must be present in a school for its effective functioning. Such resources must be in sufficient numbers, in working condition, and completely child-friendly.

Things To Do

- Think of all physical resources that may improve the child's learning.
- Ascertain whether they exist and are available to the children. For example, what use is a toilet if it is locked or available only for staff use? Similarly, a toilet that has no water or door is of no use to children.

A few of these resources are:

- *Building:* Classrooms, an office room, a kitchen shed and room for running ICDS centre. These should be of concrete, clean, airy, free of bad odor, well-lit, etc.
- *School premises:* Boundary wall, playground, flower beds, trees along the boundary, separate toilets for girls and boys in usable condition, adequate in number, and with water.
- *Learning and other resources:* Library books in the library, computers in usable condition, a laboratory with equipment, blackboards at proper height and free of glare, display boards, mats, desks and benches for students, tables and chairs for teachers etc.

- Demand for additional resources should be based on the above findings.
- Cost of repair and upkeep should be included too.

2.4 TEACHER REQUIREMENT

Definition: The number of teachers required for primary and upper primary schools as per RTE norms.

Things To Do

- Ascertain teacher requirements for the school(s), keeping in mind subject teachers for classes VI–VIII, women teachers, specialists like music, art, and PT teachers, teachers due for retirement, and needs for teachers to run bridge courses etc.
- This requirement should be compared with the number of sanctioned posts, deputations, etc. provided for already. The gap should then be covered.

2.5 TEACHER TRAINING

Definition: The RTE Act has placed some new demands on teachers. They need to be trained through refresher courses to upgrade their skills and to familiarize them with the use of new Teaching Learning Materials, child-friendly effective classroom practices, methods of comprehensive and continuous evaluation, interactive teaching, etc., are examples of training for which a demand must be made in the SDP.

Teacher trainings, both pre-service and in-service, have ignored some crucial areas in which teacher's capacities need to be developed. These are building teachers' capacity on engaging community on management and planning for schools, important roles of parents and community in child development, dealing with the first generation learners, preparing School Development Plan, and other things.

Things to Do

- Discuss the existing training calendars with the teachers to understand what sort of training they receive and for what duration. In addition, ascertain if there are any specific training programs that the teachers would like to attend.
- The timing and duration of the training programs need to be established, and follow-up training schedules should also be listed in the plan.

2.6 UNIVERSAL PARTICIPATION

Although there is almost universal enrollment in schools, regular participation of children in schools remains a challenge in a large part of the country. School attendance is low in certain periods of the year, influenced by labor requirement in agriculture or at home or illness in certain seasons of the months. The periods of low attendance and reasons behind this need to be analyzed carefully. Some children are irregular for most part of a school year. These children need to be identified. It is possible to discuss each individual case of absenteeism and the reasons for the same. The school attendance register is a good tool for monitoring attendance, but it is seldom being used. Attendance is taken routinely in schools, but the information gathered is hardly analyzed or acted upon. Some children are absent from school at a fixed hour, usually after the mid-day meal, almost every day. These cases need to be analyzed and remedies need to be found for each of these cases.



Health-related reasons also contribute to absenteeism. Children who have been absent due to health-related reasons have to be separately listed and suitable interventions need to be planned to ensure participation of such children.

The phenomenon of absenteeism is complex and it requires a careful analysis. Absenteeism may not be the result of a single factor. Initial absenteeism might have been triggered by reasons of work or illness but the most important reason of absenteeism is the non-comprehension of the subjects being taught in schools and the fearful environment of the schools.

Things To Do

- Ascertain the level of attendance in school.
- Analyze the pattern of absenteeism — months when absenteeism is higher.
- Try to understand the reasons for the absenteeism.
- Look at how many children have absented average how many days for health related reasons.
- What are the common health issues and the period during which it is on peak?
- Identify those children and have separate discussion with children and their parents.
- School register can be one of the sources of information.
- Children are an important source to know about irregular children and long absentees.
- Identify those children and have special interventions for them.
- Interventions like peer mobilization in form of *Prabhat Pheri*, community pressure can yield positive result.
- Many children will need special support in terms of filling basic learning deficits or health check-up.
- Based on the analysis, formulate nuanced interventions.

2.7 LEARNING ACHIEVEMENT

Definition: Every child should be able to fluently read and write in first language and also achieve expected levels of learning (as per her age) in other subjects as laid down by National Curriculum Framework(NCF) 2005.

Many children lack even basic literacy and numeracy skills even after continuing in the school for 3–5 years. Others have acquired these, but may suffer from learning levels below their grades. The community/SMC first needs to ascertain the learning levels of each child (a baseline for learning outcomes). Then they must plan for interventions to fill the learning deficits, in the absence of which child faces not only a non-comprehension in classroom, but in all likelihood, such children are liable to dropout of the school.

It is important to analyze why these deficits occurred and find remedies for the same. Irregular attendance, teacher shortage, lack of individualized attention, and failure to ensure basic literacy in early grades can be some of the probable reasons.

In the revised guidelines of SSA, provision for Learning Enhancement Programme(LEP) has also been made. There is adequate provision for training of teachers, but the training imparted so far has failed to meet the real needs of the teachers.

There is a need to monitor children's learning progress not for the purpose of promoting or detaining them (detaining, even otherwise, is prohibited under the Act), but to assess the performance of

the children and the school. Social audit of learning is an important step, especially when there is an apprehension that school performance is going to deteriorate further due to the non-detention policy and the absence of examinations, especially external examinations. Assessment of learning during a children's festival can be an important tool for the social audit of learning. Parents in particular, and the community in general, can witness how their children fare in different activities.

Things To Do

- First, the community must be made aware of the expected levels of learning at different grade levels. Discuss the essential learning levels for each age group with teachers and educationists in the area.
- Communicate this to all parents and teachers concerned in a manner that they understand and ensure compliance. For example, every classroom can have a clear display of what the child needs to have learnt in a month in different subjects.
- Conduct a baseline study of learning levels of children and understand what types of deficits exist.
- Draw a plan for a social audit of students' learning achievements.

The children's learning must be analyzed involving teachers and Cluster Resource Centre (CRC) members and, if there is need for interventions, the same must find place in the SDP.

2.8 UNIVERSAL RETENTION AND PROMOTION

The two aspects of universal retention and promotion are interlinked. Academic excellence is an important outcome of good schooling. In the absence of detention, there should not be a slowdown in the drive to learn and progress. Moreover, a system of evaluation must be in place to measure and rectify deviations from the minimum established expectations.

The RTE provides for annual promotion of children up to class VIII. Also, students who enroll must complete their education up to class VIII. This means that school conditions should encourage the child to continue up to class VIII. There must be continuous evaluation in all classes to ascertain the child's learning levels periodically.

Things To Do

- Establish a periodic assessment program and share it with the parent and the child.
- Where possible, bring in competent and external persons for review of learning. This will lend objectivity to the assessment process.
- Determine ways to cover any deficit discovered after evaluation. The training, referred to under the previous heading, will assist in this regard. New methods of teaching will also help.
- Have a priority plan for children of higher age bracket (above 11 years of age), and for the migrant/disadvantaged children to help them come on par with other children quickly.
- Enrich and supplement the child's learning experience in multiple ways. For example, organize day trips to nearby places and guided visits to public places and offices. Provide opportunities for the child to display his interests and talent through academic and cultural programs and encourage achievers by presenting them with awards at public functions.

2.9 SCHOOL SPORTS, ARTS, AND MUSIC

2.9.1 GAMES AND SPORTS

When we think of holistic education, that is, education bringing all-round development of the child,



we cannot restrict our school activities to the academic sphere alone. Games and sports, arts, and music are essential to a school curriculum.

Sports and games are necessary not only for their physical benefits. They teach children to work as a team and to be team leaders. Increase in self-esteem and mental alertness are important by-products of sports and games, making them necessary for every school child. The physical benefits of sports are immense. They help children maintain a healthy weight, prevent chronic illnesses, and also give the children skills necessary to maintain a healthy lifestyle after graduating from school. RTE norms provide for a playground and games and sports equipment for each school.

2.9.2 ARTS AND MUSIC

There are innumerable benefits of arts and music in children's lives. Art can provide an emotional mode for communicating subconscious feelings and is, therefore, good for a person's emotional development. The increasing realization that emotional intelligence or Emotional Quotient (EQ) is as vital a life skill, a greater emphasis should be given to art education in schools. Involvement in the arts is associated with gains in math, reading, cognitive ability, critical thinking, and verbal skills. Learning of arts can also contribute towards improving motivation, concentration, confidence, and teamwork.

RTE norms provide for teachers for Physical education and also for Arts, and Music on a shared basis for every two schools. while formulating SDP if teachers for these activities are not available in the schools the demand for the same can be included in the SDP.

There are enough resources available in the community in the areas of sports, arts, and music. There should be efforts to make use of the local resources as well.

Things To Do

- If there is no teacher for sports, arts, or music, place a demand for the same in your plan.
- Until teachers are provided, local resources may be used to begin these activities.
- In the school timetable, create a space for these activities.
- Sensitize teachers and parents on the importance of sports, arts, and music.

2.10 SCHOOL CHILDREN'S HEALTH

Children's health has a bearing on school attendance and performance. One of the important reasons for irregular attendance of children in schools has been their poor health. Many children will require nutrition support, eye care, hearing aids, de-worming treatment, among other things. Inculcating hygienic practices in children is extremely important. Schools must plan for school health programs in collaboration with the local health departments. School health programs are operating in most of the states. The interventions planned under school health initiative need to be concretized and an implementation calendar also needs to be put in place.

Things To Do

- Make an assessment of the current health program(s) available to children.
- If there are health checkups for children, how frequently are these organized?
- What are the checkups facilities extended?
- Whether there has been regular follow-up on Doctor's advices?
- Whether children are provided necessary appliances/aids?
- There exists a provision for providing appliances like hearing aids, glasses, etc., to needy

children under the SSA.

- Fund available for CSN can be used.
- In coordination with PHC or local hospitals and the Panchayat, a calendar for regular health checkups and follow up can be drawn.
- Inculcating hygienic practices in cooking, eating, etc., has to be given due attention.

2.11 BUDGETING

Preparing a budget for the proposed activities based on SSA norms is another important task for the planning team. As stated earlier, if provisions for certain activities do not exist in SSA, the committee should not exclude them from the plan ambit, but should source necessary funds from other channels, such as community contribution, the Panchayat fund, the MPLAD fund, special schemes fund, and others.

States have different financial norms for construction of school buildings. Even within a state, different norms are possible for different regions, based on factors such as transportation, labor rate, and other factors. If the planning team is not aware of the unit cost for construction in their area, they need not cost this item and may mention as per the state norms, unless they want to add certain costs over and above what is provided in the norm for better and improved infrastructure. Similarly, states have different categories of teachers with different types of pay packages. Planning team may not be able to cost it due to lack of knowledge about the norms of salary for different grades and types of teachers. They can leave the item without doing costing for it.

There may be many activities that can be carried out with community contribution. To the extent possible, costing for these activities should be done and the plan should specify that these will be implemented through community contribution.

2.12 IMPLEMENTATION PLAN AND THE TIMELINE WITH MAJOR MILESTONES

Unless an implementation plan with clearly laid out timelines and responsibilities is prepared, activities will not be implemented properly. Some periods of the year might witness a lot of activities while other periods may be too lean on the activity front. The planning team should prepare an implementation plan with a clear timeline for each activity, to the extent possible. This will help implement the plan, as well as help monitor the progress of the implementation. The annual school calendar issued by district or state education officers should be used while scheduling activities. After completing this, the plan must once again be placed before the community for finalization. After finalisation, a copy of the plan should be sent to the relevant CRC or any other relevant authorities designated by the state governments.

3. USING VILLAGE EDUCATION REGISTER(VER) FOR TRACKING PROGRESS OF EVERY CHILD

RTE Act 2009 envisages non detention policy. There is a large scale apprehension that this might lead to further deterioration in the quality of learning in schools. Non detention presupposes regular assessment of the children as well as individualized attention to every child. If parents ensure children's regular attendance and schools ensure proper learning environment and support to each child, there is no reason why children will not learn. Presently both parents and schools are unable to ensure these crucial aspects. Children do not get individualized attention, classroom atmosphere and teacher child relationship are not conducive for learning.

It should be possible for the community to plan for the development of physical and social infrastructure of schools and also for enrollment, participation, continuation and promotion of every



child. Promotion also presupposes adequate learning achievement for every child. These core issues have to be monitored regularly by the SMC.

VER is an appropriate tool for doing so. Based on the household survey a family wise record of each child is kept in the VER and using this tool child wise progress can be monitored by the SMC. Since child progress is monitored every quarter, this also provide opportunity for intervention and taking corrective actions by the community and teachers.



CHAPTER FIVE: STORIES OF CHANGE

1. SMC'S STRUGGLE FOR CREATING A SAFE SCHOOL ENVIRONMENT FOR CHILDREN

Barpadar is a small village in Litiguda Gram Panchayat in Sinapali block of Nauapada district in Odisha. The village is covered under Learning and Migration programme (LAMP), run by Lokdrushti with support from American India Foundation. School Management Committee (SMC) members were trained on the provisions of the RTE Act as well as on the roles and responsibilities of the SMC while managing a school. SMC meetings are held regularly in the village. Self Help Group members and village youth were trained on the implementation of RTE.

In a meeting of SMC members and the community on October 22, 2011, they decided to bring two important issues to the notice of the block and district administration.

One issue concerned the location of an electricity transformer in the school. It was positioned within the school campus and posed a risk to children's lives. The other issue pertained to a request for building some additional classrooms.



The SMC wrote an application raising these two issues and addressed it to the District Collector. A copy each was sent to the Block Development Officer (BDO), Block Resource Centre Coordinator (BRCC), and District Inspector (DI) of Schools. An application was also sent to the Education Secretary, Government of Odisha, but no action was taken on their application. They again contacted the BDO and BRCC office enquiring about the follow up on these issues. They even approached the Electricity Supply Board, but no result came out of that.

Ultimately, the villagers took a decision to close the school till the time these issue were resolved. They informed the local police, the BDO and the BRCC regarding their decision. Lokdrushti also discussed the issue with the District Collector and the media. The matter was highlighted in the electronic and print media.

As a result of all this, block officials, including the BDO, the BRCC, the Sub Inspector of Schools(SIS) and the Cluster Resource Centre Coordinator(CRCC) reached the school and promised necessary action. An amount of Rs 50,000 was sanctioned for shifting the transformer and a sum of Rs 1,14,000 was released immediately for classroom construction. Even after this, the electricity transformer was not relocated. Thereafter, the villagers filed an RTI application. This finally made the administration take action upon the issue and the transformer was relocated to a safe place in November 2012. The classrooms' construction is also about to finish and will be

available for use by March 2013.

SMC and the village community have taken up the issue of education of children from migrant families. As a result of the SMC's active intervention this year (2012–13), 10 boys and eight girls are staying with caregivers, while their families have migrated. No child has migrated this year and the village has declared itself is a child migration free village.

Similarly, SMC of Kamalamal Ashram School also fought for removal of an electric transformer and succeeded in their effort. There was an electric transformer within school campus, and an 1100 KV electric wire was passing above the school building. Not only did it risk the lives of children, but it also remained a hindrance for building of new classrooms. As it is an Ashram school with more than 300 children from classes I to VIII resident, there was requirement for more classrooms. Due to limitation of land, SMC decided to build another floor for classrooms. This, though, was not possible due to the high tension electric wire passing above the building. The SMC brought the matter before the authorities many times, even meeting the District Collector. The District Collector also sanctioned an amount of Rs 5,00,000 for this purpose from Integrated Action Plan (IAP) fund, but implementation process was very slow. Finally, SMC members had to resort to closing the school and sitting on a dharna on July 30, 2012. Finally, the administration responded and took immediate action to shift the transformer.

2. SMC SUCCEEDS IN GETTING SAFE DRINKING WATER FOR SCHOOLS

Jarelpadar is a small village in Sinapali block, Odisha. The Jarelpadar school did not have drinking water supply and children had to go to their home to drink water.

The SMC along with the village youth took up the issue of ensuring safe drinking water in school. They wrote an application regarding the matter to the BDO and requested him to personally look into the matter. The BDO immediately sent a Rural Water Supply and Sanitation (RWSS) Junior Engineer (JE) to the village.

The JE saw to it that the water pipeline was extended to the school and also set the water supply timings as per the school's schedule. Now there is no water scarcity in the school and children are enjoying their time at school.

This entire episode has given tremendous confidence to the community and the SMC, with the support of the youth group, has identified some other issues for improving their schools. They have included this in the School Development Plan prepared by them, and submitted it to the authorities. They are planning collective action on some of these issues.

Motivated by the initiatives of the SMC and members of the local community, along with the success of the learning support classes being run under LAMP, school teachers have started visiting absentee children's home and motivating parents not to engage children in household or agriculture work during school hours. All 107 children aged 6–14 years in this village are now enrolled in the school. During follow up of students' attendance by head counting in December 2012 and January 2013, 93 per cent children were found present in school. Now one can witness school teachers seriously engaging in classroom transaction during teaching hours. Teachers are also enjoying this change in the situation along with the children and the local community. Jarelpadar is a migration prone village. Jarelpadar SMC is one among the 85 SMCs which sent a proposal to Education Secretary for opening of seasonal hostels for children belonging to mi-

grant families. Even they placed a proposal for hostel in their School Development Plan. Now a seasonal hostel is running in the school, and 23 boys and 20 girls from migrant families are residing in it.

This village became a child migration free village this year. No child has to leave school due to migration.

3. SMC'S ACTIVISM ENSURE TEACHERS BEING PUNCTUAL TO SCHOOL

Teachers usually came late to the primary and upper primary schools in Tanwat, a village 5 kms from the district headquarter of Nuapada in Odisha. Although the schools were located quite close to the district headquarter, education was the most neglected in this village. Teachers of the upper primary school were not punctual in coming to school.

During the RTE campaign organized to mobilize community on issues of child rights and familiarize them with the key provisions in the RTE Act, a village meeting was organized on September 12, 2011. Parents of children, along with the SMC members, the SHG members, youth and PRI representatives, attended this meeting.

They understood that quality education is a right of their children and the SMC constituted from among them have important roles and responsibilities in ensuring their children's rights. The SMC made a request to the teachers for coming punctually, but the teachers' did not heed their request.

Finally, after nearly a month, the SMC Chairman, along with other members, locked the main gate of the school when they found teachers were absent until 10.30 a.m. Teachers came and were surprised to find the gate locked. They had to wait outside the entire day. The next day, the teachers came on time and they continue to do so till date.

Teachers coming late to schools is a very common practice in this tribal dominated district. The SMC of the Godfula school, covered under LAMP intervention, initially tried a dialogue with the teachers to ensure their timely attendance at school.

When they realized that dialogue and persuasion was not bearing any result, the SMC passed a resolution in its meeting against the late coming of teachers and they jointly visited the District Inspector (DI) of schools. They submitted a written application requesting DI's intervention in this matter. The DI summoned all the teachers and issued a warning. Now teachers are reaching school on time. Thus, the SMC succeeded in their first attempt towards school reforms.

4. SMCS WITH SUPPORT FROM LAMP SUCCEEDED IN GETTING SANCTION FROM SSA FOR SEASONAL HOSTELS

As a result of SMCs efforts supported by Lokdrushti, 60 RCCs were sanctioned for 2319 children in Nuapada district, of which 32 are in LAMP operational area. SMCs submitted list of children who will require seasonal hostel facility to continue their study while their families migrate for work. These seasonal hostels are being run by the SMC, with guidance and support being provided by the LAMP functionaries. This is a very interesting experience where community is not only taking initiatives but taking responsibility to run seasonal hostel funded by the government. Success of this initiative will pave way for a large expansion of the programme in new areas.

It is also important to note that provisions for seasonal hostels and learning of migrant children get importance in SDPs prepared by the SMCs.

5. SMC SUCCEEDS IN CREATING CONSENSUS AMONG COMMUNITY ON ACCESSING INCENTIVE FOR CHILDREN

Primary School Mandiri, Patna, is located in the middle of the China Kothi slum settlement. The SMC members of the school were oriented on rights and responsibilities of SMC under the RTE Act. The SMC of this school is active and the members take keen interest in school affairs. In January 2013, the school had to distribute money for school uniforms to students. There was serious chaos and confrontation among parents for receiving this money. Parents of many children who were enrolled in private schools were also staking claim to the uniform money. The SMC, together with the school Head Master (HM), organized distribution of the incentive amount. They decided to exclude all the children who were studying in private schools from the beneficiary list. This could be possible only because of the active involvement of SMC in school affairs. SMC has taken responsibility for Mid Day Meal (MDM), and in their monthly meeting they regularly monitor attendance of the children. There has been a 60 per cent increase in school enrollment, and average attendance has also improved significantly. Some of the noticeable improvements are timely opening and closing of school, teachers being regular and punctual in school, and use of different teaching learning material in the classroom by teachers.

6. SMC INTERVENTION HELP IMPROVING TEACHER COMMUNITY RELATIONSHIP

The SMC of the Debisar village School under Fatehpur Panchayat of Rapar Block in Kutch district of Gujarat has taken many initiatives to improve their schools in the last two years, after they were oriented on the rights and responsibilities of the SMC under the LAMP–Government of Gujarat initiatives. This village is inhabited by the Parkara Koli community which migrated from Pakistan, and is one of the most backward communities of Gujarat. Almost the entire population of the village are daily wage earners. Many engage in charcoal making, while many families migrate to salt pans. The village has a school for grade one to eight, with seven teachers as staff. Some teachers have been coming to school from faraway places and very often reaching late. The SMC has been able to arrange accommodation for the teachers in the village to ensure that the teachers would not have to waste so much time in commuting and they reach school in time. With SMCs efforts, the school has got two new classrooms and have been able to erect a boundary wall. Trees have been planted inside the school compound and each of the trees have been adopted by children, community and the teachers, who are responsible for watering and protecting these trees.

Most girls were dropping out after grade five from the schools due to work pressure. After community consultation, SMC decided to introduce some vocational courses in the schools to ensure continuation of girls beyond grade five. This has resulted in more girls continuing in the school and two girls have reached grade seven.

7. SMC ENSURES SAFE SCHOOL BUILDING FOR THE CHILDREN

The SMC of Kumbhariya village school under Rapar Taluka of Kutch succeeded in ensuring quality of construction of additional classrooms. The village has about 250 households consisting of Kolis, Ahirs and Dalit communities. They all belong to backward sections of the society. Most people of the village are small farmers. Cattle rearing and wage labor are their main source of earning. Dalits and the Kolis are primarily daily wage laborers. Some families migrate to salt pans as well.





आमचे हक्क
जिव्यांचा
सहंगाचा
संरक्षणाचा
प्रगट करणाऱ्या

शेटी खेल
पढाई प
हर बच्चे का
अ

The SMC of the village school proposed five additional rooms, which were duly sanctioned. Since the present school campus was not sufficient, they had to develop a new campus with a boundary wall. The SMC managed to get additional piece of land for the school. When the Sarpanch of the village engaged contractors for construction of the school building, the SMC members provided them specifications to ensure construction quality. Since it is an earthquake prone area, the SMC was very particular that the structure must have sufficient beams and columns, and it should also be earthquake resistant. Initially, both the Sarpanch and the contractor showed unwillingness to accept their proposal on the pretext that it would lead to increase in cost of construction. The SMC members proposed that they would mobilize additional funds from the community if there would be an escalation in the construction cost. They also expressed to the contractor, in unambiguous terms, that the entire construction will be supervised by the community. As a result, five classrooms in a new campus with a boundary wall got constructed within the sanctioned amount, at the same time adhering to the quality prescribed by the SMC.

Girls' education has been the most neglected aspect in this village. As a result of community efforts, 11 girls have gone to grade eight in this village. The nearest high school is in Gagodar, approximately 17 kms from the village with very little facility of transport. Some boys travel this distance to attend high schools, but no girl will be able to do so. Realizing this, the SMC has made a demand for upgrading their schools up to grade ten.

The SMC has also arranged for accommodation for school teachers in the village which help teachers save commuting time and spend adequate time in school.

8. SMCS INTERVENTION TO ENSURE REGULAR AND PROPER SUPPLY OF MID-DAY MEAL IN SCHOOL

The SMC of Zillah Parishad School in Mehekar block of Buldhana district of Maharashtra took up the issue of poor implementation of the Mid-Day Meal (MDM) in the school. The SMC first analysed the issue and then discussed it with the parents of the schoolchildren. The SMC and the community jointly appealed to the Education Officer and the school principal for ensuring quality of MDM. However, the situation did not improve until the SMC members went to the office of the Director, Education at Pune and gave an ultimatum of holding a press meet to share their plight with the media.

After intervention of the Director, Education, MDM quality improved. This has been one of the examples of SMCs and the parents getting together for bringing about a change in the implementation of a Government scheme.

ANNEX:

SCHOOL DEVELOPMENT PLAN

SUBMITTED TO:

BLOCK RESOURCE CENTER COORDINATOR, KHARIAR

PREPARED BY:

SCHOOL MANAGEMENT COMMITTEE, AND
PARENTS AND TEACHERS ASSOCIATION (PTA)

SUPPORTED BY:

YOUTH AND ADOLESCENT GIRLS GROUP

TECHNICAL SUPPORT:

LOKADRUSTI, KHARIAR, ODISHA

PLAN FOR 2012-2013, 2013-2014, 2014-2015

Name of the School	Center Primary School
Name of the Village/Hamlet	Khamtarai
Name of the Revenue Village	Khamtarai
Name of the Cluster (CRC)	Saradhapur
Name of the Gram Panchayat	Duajhar
Name of the Block	Khariar
Name of the District	Nuapada
Grades in the school	1 - 5

SCHOOL PROFILES AT A GLANCE

Sl No.	Description	Response
1	School Code (DISE):	0307201
2	Contact No of HM & Chairperson, SMC	HM-09178618861 Chairman - 07894524667
3	Year of Establishment	15-11-1958
4	Residential/Ashram School/KGBV/Non-Residential	Non-Residential
5	AWC/ECCE functioning in the same campus	No
6	Constitution of SMC & No. of Members in the SMC	Yes on dt. 11-01-2011/13
7	Mid-day Meal Facility & Management	Yes/Managed by SMC
8	Availability of Kitchen Room	Yes
9	School Management (S&ME/SSD/SSD/any other department)	School & Mass Education Dept.
10	Type of school (Boys/Girls/Co-Ed)	Co-Educational
11	Availability of fire extinguisher	Yes
12	Availability of computer	No
13	No. of all weather class room	03
14	No. of class rooms connected with ramps	02
16	Availability of common/boy's toilet	Yes - 01
17	Availability of safe drinking water facility	Tube well water which contains flourisde
18	Availability of playground	No
19	Availability of electricity	No
20	Availability of boundary wall/fencing	Yes - not completed
21	Availability of library	No
22	No. of children studying	157
23	Daily school working hour	6 hour
24	No. of teachers	04
25	Availability of play materials	Yes - not sufficient
26	Availability of display/information board	Yes
27	Availability of TLM/TLE	Yes - but insufficient

1. INTRODUCTION

Khamtarai is a small village under Khariar block of Nuapada district, Odisha. It has a population of 1,616 from 295 house hold. There are 834 male and 782 female. Among them 245 are in the 6-14 years age group. About 90 % families belong to SC, ST communities (68 SC, 195 ST, 26 OBC and 6 minority families). and majority are marginal farmers and laborers. 92% families are under Below Poverty Line(BPL). About 30-40 families are regular migrant (one/two members of family migrate throughout the year) to cities like Raipur, Nagpur etc, where as 30-40 families migrate seasonally to brick-kiln of Andhra Pradesh/Karnataka etc.

There is a Primary and an Upper Primary School in the village. The nearest high school (class VIII to X) in Duajhar is 3 K.M. from this village. Under provision of the RTE Act 2009, SMCs were constituted for both the schools. As per RTE guidelines SMCs undertook the task of preparing School Development Plan (SDP). In preparing SDP members of the youth group and Lokadrusti staff extended support.

2. PROCESS OF SCHOOL DEVELOPMENT PLAN PREPARATION

Preparatory meeting for plan preparation was organised which included parents, teachers and members of village youth group. it was presided over by the SMC chairperson Mr.Rikhiram Majhi. Mr.Mohan Majhi, Head Master cum convenor of the SMC after welcoming the participants explained various steps of preparing SDP like, developing vision of school, fixing school catchment area, primary data collection through household survey, social mapping, school mapping, infrastructure mapping, teachers' plan, learning plan and plan for children needing special attention. Members of the committee first determined the school catchment area which covers Khamtarai, Gurjibhata, Tribenipada, Gudipada and Bandhpada habitations. All these hamlets are within one K.M. distance from the school.

During the discussion issues such provision of safe drinking water, as school tube well water contains fluoride, education of children effected by migration, adequate provision of play materials were deliberated. It was decided to request Junior Engineer(RWSS) to extend water supply connection to school campus and supply one water filter in each class. It was also decided to identify the migration prone households in social mapping and persuading migrant parents to leave children in seasonal hostel or in care of their extended family members. It was also decided to make provisions of seasonal hostel in SDP. members also raised concern about many class IV and V children unable to read and write even the text books of class I and II and they decided to make provisions for Learning support classes for these children. From their experience of LEP classes run under LAMP they also decided to keep provisions for teachers' training on such learning courses. It was also decided to seek help from Lokadrusti on it. Discussions also included issues such as making provision for teaching and learning materials, books and uniforms, electric facilities in school, Radio, television and computer facilities for students and improving quality of MDM.

Finally it was decided to undertake visioning exercise and then prepare SDP with keeping in view the issues raised in the meeting and the community vision of school. Sub-committees for information gathering and undertaking social mapping exercise were formed and they were awarded with specific responsibilities. And these two sub-committees based on the information together were assigned responsibility for developing draft plan. It was decided to hold another meeting for a presentation of draft plan and finalization for submission. The entire process was completed within a fortnight.

2.1 SCHOOL VISION EXERCISE

Center Primary School, Khamtarai was established on 15.11.1958. It started functioning in a small hut prepared by the villagers. At that time very few children attended school. At present 157 children are studying from class I to Vth. The school visioning exercise was undertaken by the community which led to articulation of the vision. The vision can be summarized as;

- 1) all children of the village should enrolled and attend school regularly without fear and any discrimination.
- 2)The school should be one among the best school in the district in respect to child friendly facilities and atmosphere and quality of education.

2.3 SOCIAL MAPPING

A social map was prepared on a drawing sheet, using colour pencil to describe basic facilities in the village, socio-economic condition and educational status and also to ensure larger participation. Information such as migrant house hold (HH), migrant family with 6-14 year children, families with Drop Outs, Never Enrolled and CWSN children were gathered through social mapping exercise. Besides all HH in the village, school, AWC, road, well, hand pump and other resources were identified in it. The map helps in describing the village education status and bringing out a road map for further development.

2.4 PRIMARY DATA COLLECTION THROUGH HOUSEHOLD SURVEY

Socio-economic, educational and demographic data of all HH in the village was collected during HH survey on a specially designed format. Especially information about 3-5 and 6-14 year children like; school enrollment, drop outs, never enrolled, CWSN and information of migrating children were collected.

The information collected was matched with the Primary school DISE data, AWWC data and data from village migration register (Lokadrusti). A final set of data on school enrollment, drop outs, never enrolled, and migrating children are attached here with this document.

2.5 INFRASTRUCTURE MAPPING

School Management Committee with support from guardians and teachers prepared an infrastructure map of primary school. This included information on class room, TLM, furniture and other infrastructure of the school. Also included plan for further requirement of the school. A set of information and plan are attached here with.

2.6. FOCUS GROUP DISCUSSION

Planning team members sat with villagers to have in-depth discussion on ensuring enrollment of every child in the school, including never enrolled and drop out children and also about ensuring regular attendance of all children.

This generated a discussion about need for sufficient and qualified teachers and need for plan for teachers' requirement and training plan and also plan for children with special needs (CWSN) and children of migrant families.

Further team prepared a draft plan, which included all the points emerging from the exercises and also a financial estimate for each intervention.

2.7 SHARING IN VILLAGE MEETING

Draft school development plan was shared in a village meeting for information and opinion of the villagers on dt.14.04.12. Finally SDP was presented before the SMC and approved for submission to Block Resource Center Coordinator.

3. CATCHMENT AREA AND NO. OF HABITATIONS IN THE NEIGHBORHOOD OF THE SCHOOL

Main habitation of Khamtarai and Gudipada, Gurjibhatapada, Chatiapada and Bandhapada hamlets of Khamtarai revenue village are coming under school catchment area.

PRIMARY					
Name of the Habitation	Distance from the school (KM)	No. of 6-11 years children	No. of children enrolled	No. of never enrolled/drop out children	Children enrolled in outside school (other village school)
Khamtarai	Within 1 KM	157	157	0	0

4. NO. OF CHILDREN OF 4-5 YEARS AGE

Category	Gen incl. OBC		SC		ST		Total		Muslims		PL (Gen incl. OBC)		CWSN	
	B	G	B	G	B	G	B	G	B	G	B	G	B	G
4 Years	2	4	4	4	8	12	14	20	0	0	2	4	0	0
5 Years	0	2	2	3	13	14	15	19	0	0	0	2	0	0
Total	2	6	6	7	21	26	29	39	0	0	2	6	0	0

5. ENROLLMENT - PROJECTION OF ENROLLMENT IN THREE YEARS (2012-13, 2013-14 & 2014-15)

5 (A). ENROLLMENT IN 2012-13 (ENROLLMENT AS AVAILABLE IN THE REGISTER OF PRESENT YEAR)

Category	I		II		III		IV		V		TOTAL		
	B	G	B	G	B	G	B	G	B	G	B	G	Total
Gen incl. OBC	0	0	1	2	4	2	0	0	1	2	6	6	12
SC	1	0	2	0	3	2	6	1	8	2	20	5	25
ST	7	10	14	10	13	13	6	9	13	22	53	64	117
Total	8	10	17	12	21	17	12	11	23	26	81	76	157
Muslims	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
BPL (Gen.incl. OBC)	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
CWSN	0	0	0	0	0	0	1	0	1	1	2	1	3

5 B. ENROLLMENTS IN 2013-14

Category	I		II		III		IV		V		TOTAL		
	B	G	B	G	B	G	B	G	B	G	B	G	Total
Gen incl. OBC	0	2	0	0	1	2	4	2	0	0	5	6	11
SC	2	3	1	0	2	0	3	2	6	1	14	6	20
ST	13	14	7	10	14	10	13	13	6	9	53	56	109
Total	15	19	8	10	17	12	21	17	12	10	73	63	136
Muslims	0	0	0	0	0	0	1	0	0	0	1	0	1
BPL (Gen.incl. OBC)	0	2	0	0	1	2	4	2	0	0	5	6	11
CWSN	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1	0	1	0	1

5 C. ENROLLMENTS IN 2014-15

Category	I		II		III		IV		V		TOTAL		
	B	G	B	G	B	G	B	G	B	G	B	G	Total
Gen incl. OBC	2	4	0	2	0	0	1	2	4	2	7	10	17
SC	4	4	2	3	1	0	2	0	3	2	12	9	21
ST	8	12	13	14	7	10	14	10	13	13	55	59	114
Total	14	20	15	19	8	10	17	12	21	17	74	78	152
Muslims	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1	0	1	0	1
BPL (Gen.incl. OBC)	2	4	0	2	0	0	1	2	4	2	8	10	18
CWSN	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0

- Enrolment in Class -1 for 2013-14 and 2014-15 may be equal to children in 5 and 4 years age in the habitations around the school as it is figured in Table-5 respectively.
- Enrolment figure from Class-II, III, IV & V in 2013-14 and 2014-15 will be equal to enrollment figure of Class-I, II, III & IV in 2012-13 and 2013-14 respectively.

6. TEACHER

From discussion it was evident that following teachers came to school regularly. They were friendly with children. Teachers' relationship with parents and SMC is very good and it helps in building educational environment in the village. Classroom transaction of teachers is of satisfactory level.

PRESENT STATUS OF TEACHERS/HM IN THE SCHOOL (TEACHER IN POSITION)

Name of Teacher	Designation	Male/ Female	Under state Govt/ SSA	Primary/ UP	Academic Qualification	Professional qualiication
	(HM/Asst. Tr)					
Mohan Majhi	In charge HM	Male	State Govt.	Primary	10+	C.T.
Udhaba Meher	Asst. Tr.	Male	SSA	Primary	+2	
Kusum Nag	Asst. Tr.	Female	SSA	Primary	+2	
Padmanav Harpal	Asst. Tr.	Male	SSA	Primary	+2	

6 A. REQUIREMENT OF TEACHER AT PRIMARY LEVEL (I-V) AS PER RTE

SI No.	Year	Enrollment (Class I-V)	*Entitlement of teacher as per RTE Norm		Net requirement of Teachers & HM = <i>Entitlement - teacher in position (Point - 7)</i>	
			Teachers	HM		
1	2	3	4	5	6 (Teacher)	7 (HM)
1	2012-13	157	5	1	1	1
2	2013-14	137	5	1	0	0
3	2014-15	153	5	1	0	0

6 B. FINANCIAL REQUIREMENTS FOR PROVIDING TEACHER SALARY UNDER SSA

SI No.	Activities	Unit Cost (In Rs.)	Physical (Teacher under SSA)	Financial (1 Yr.)	Financial (2 Yr.)	Financial (3 Yrs.)
1	Primary (Gala Sikhyaka)	2250	04	108000	108000	108000
	Subtotal	2250	04	108000	108000	108000

7. INFRASTRUCTURE

Requirements of school as came out of discussion were given below. These are plan in respect to safety; place as per need; child friendly elements and building an environment helpful for students learning.

7 A. REQUIREMENT OF INFRASTRUCTURE AS PER RTE

Component	Requirement as per RTE	Available (In Nos.)	Net Requirement
	1	2	3=(1-2)
Additional Classroom	5	3	2
Common/Boy's Toilet	2	1	1
Separate Girls Toilet	3	1	2
Safe and sufficient drinking water facilities (deep bore well)	1	0	1
Head Master's Room	1	1	0
Boundary Wall/Fencing	Needs	Incomplete	Needs to be completed
Play Ground	Needs	No	Govt. Land near school proposed for play ground
Ramps with Hand Rail in Classroom, Toilet & Drinking water point	05	02	03
Kitchen room for MDM	1	0	1

7 B. OTHER INFRASTRUCTURE FACILITY

Component	Requirement	Available	Net Requirement
	1	2	3=(1-2)
Child Friendly Elements - BALA	01	00	01
Electrification (Electric connection, electrification, 4 CFL Balb and 2 fan in each room)	05	0	05
Balti, Jug & Brush for use in toilet	05	0	05
Soap and Finale	05	0	05
Major Repairs (Primary)	02	0	02

7 C. BUDGETING FOR INFRASTRUCTURE FACILITY

Sl No.	Activities	Unit Cost (In Rs.)	Physical (Units)	Financial (1 Yr.)	Financial (2 Yr.)	Financial (3 Yrs.)	Time of doing the activity
1	Additional Classroom	4,10,000	2	8,20,000			
2	Common/boy's Toilet	70,000	2	1,40,000			
3	Separate Girls Toilet	70,000	2	1,40,000			
4	Special toilet for CWSN	30,000	1	30,000			
5	Safe and sufficient drinking water facilities (deep bore well)	3,00,000	1	3,00,000			
6	Safe and sufficient drinking water facilities (water filter)	5,000	5	25,000			
7	Head Master's Room	0	0	0			
8	Boundary Wall/ Fencing	1,50,000	1	1,50,000			
9	Play Ground	1,00,000	1	1,00,000			
10	Ramps with Hand Rail in Classroom, Toilet & Drinking Water Point	8,000	3	24,000			
11	Kitchen room for MDM	4,10,000	1	4,10,000			
12	Child Friendly Elements - BALA	45,000	1	45,000			
13	Electrification (electric connection, electrification, 4 CFL Balb and 2 fan in each room)	20,000	5	60,000	40,000		
14	Balti, Jug & Brush for use in toilet	1,000	5	5,000	5,000	5,000	
15	Soap and finale	1,000	5	5,000	5,000	5,000	
16	Major Repairs (Primary)	2,46,000	2	4,92,000			
17	Gardening			5,000	2,000	2,000	
SUB TOTAL					52,000	12,000	

8. ACTION PLAN FOR ENROLLMENT OUT OF SCHOOL CHILDREN & ENSURING RETENTION

- Enrolment of never enrolled and drop out children in school by motivating their parents.
- Age appropriate class admission of children, those are not reading in age appropriate class.
- Provisioning of bridge course/special training to fill deficit of never enrolled, drop out and children not in age appropriate class.

9. PLAN FOR RETENTION OF CHILDREN

- Monthly review of students' attendance and listing of irregular students. Find out types (long absentee, children absent frequently and absentee for few days) and causes of irregularity
- Sharing in monthly meeting among SMC members and plan to share with the parents
- Home visit by SMC members and teacher
- Organization of health check up camp to address seasonal health problem of children
- Making school environment and classroom child friendly
- Promotion of sports and co curricular activities among children
- Use of bell to make children punctual and ensure quality of food in MDM
- Plan to fill learning deficit of children and motivating them towards education
- Promoting child club through regular meetings, sanitary awareness, games and cultural activities

9 A. PLAN FOR BRIDGE COURSE/SPECIAL TRAINING FOR 2012-13

During house hold survey and social mapping we find out 13 students those needs special learning support. We have plan for one year bridge course for them. List of students and plan for bridge course given below in table.

SI No.	Name of the child	Age	Class to which get admission	Reason for deficit learning or drop out
1	Satyaban Majhi	7	II	Drop out due to migration
2	Jamuna Majhi	9	III	Drop out due to migration
3	Mandara Majhi	8	III	Low learning level to engagement in domestic purpose
4	Madhuri Majhi	8	III	Drop out due to migration
5	Bidyadhar Majhi	8	III	Low learning level due to less attendance
6	Parmananda Majhi	10	IV	Low learning level to engagement in domestic purpose
7	Chouban Majhi	10	IV	Low learning level to engagement in domestic purpose
8	Sunya Kumar Majhi	10	IV	Low learning level due to irregular for sickness
9	Kousalya Majhi	10	IV	Low learning level due to irregular schooling. She was enrolled in SC/ST department Ashram school, Nehena.
10	Chhipi Majhi	10	IV	Low learning level to engagement in domestic purpose
11	Sasmita Majhi	10	IV	Low learning level due to irregular schooling. She was enrolled in SC/ST department Ashram school, Nehena.
12	Pinki Majhi	10	IV	Low learning level to engagement in domestic purpose
13	Padmani Majhi	10	IV	Low learning level to engagement in domestic purpose

9B. PLAN FOR BRIDGING LEARNING DEFICIT

Children enrolled in age appropriate class							Time required for learning support (in month)					
Age	No of children		Class II	Class III	Class IV	Class V	3	6	9	12	15	18
	Boys	Girls										
7	1	0	1	0	0	0	0	1	0	0	0	0
8	1	2	0	3	0	0	3	0	0	0	0	0
9	0	1	0	1	0	0	0	1	0	0	0	0
10	3	5	0	0	8	0	3	5	0	0	0	0
11	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0

An education volunteer will be appointed by the SMC to run the bridge course camp. An amount of Rs.78000/- (13 children @ Rs.6000 per child) will be required for the purpose. It will be non residential and will starts from July 2012 and run till March 2013. Or will request volunteer organization Lokadrusti to provide after and before school learning support to them.

9 C. INTERVENTIONS FOR CHILDREN WHO MIGRATE WITH THEIR PARENTS:

To ensure education of children of migrant families seasonal hostels will be set up with support from SSA from October to June every year. For which migration sensitive families were identified in during social mapping exercise and HH survey. A seasonal hostel was proposed and it was decided to persuade parents to leave as many children as possible under care of relatives and members of their extended family.

Duration of seasonal hostel	Unit Cost	1st year expected enrollment			2nd Year expected Enrollment			3rd Year expected Enrollment		
		Boys	Girls	Total	Boys	Girls	Total	Boys	Girls	Total
9 months	10,000	18	22	40	21	20	41	22	16	38

10. PLAN FOR CHILDREN WITH SPECIAL NEEDS

10 A. PLAN FOR EDUCATION OF CHILDREN NEEDS SPECIAL ATTENTION (CHILDREN WITH SPECIAL NEEDS)

There are four children with special needs in the village and there is need of special teacher and materials for them. The details are as below in table.

SI No	Activities	Sub-Activities	Unit Cost (in Rs.)	Phys-ical	1st Financial Year	2nd Financial Year	3rd Financial Year	Duration of Imple-mentation
1	Muka (2)	Hearing tools			10,000			
2	Blind (1)	Braille books & materials			10,000	10,000	10,000	
3	Special Teacher			1	1,20,000	1,20,000	1,20,000	
Total					1,40,000	1,30,000	1,30,000	

10 B. PLAN FOR GIRLS EDUCATION

During discussion it came out that absence of separate toilets for girls had adverse impact on attendance and continuity of girls in school. Therefore special toilet for girls has been planned in infrastructure mapping. And to encourage them towards school education it has been planned to arrange adequate sports materials for them. Meena club will be strengthened for sharing of child rights and girls child issues among them and SMC. It has been planned to have quarterly meeting of mothers to discuss the issues of girls children to ensure their attendance in school.

SI No	Activities	Sub-Activities	Unit Cost (in Rs.)	Physical	1st Financial Year	2nd Financial Year	3rd Financial Year	Duration of Implementation
1	Sports Materials	Ring ball, skipping rope		50 unit	5,000	5,000	5,000	Yearly
		Chess, Luddu, Carom, Football		5 set	10,000	10,000	10,000	Yearly
2	Meena club	Monthly Meeting						
2	Mothers' meeting			04	1,000	1,000	1,000	Quarterly
Total					16,000	16,000	16,000	

11. PLANNING FOR ENSURING QUALITY EDUCATION IN SCHOOL

To ensure quality education of every child in the school, learning materials as per requirement will be provided in each class room in adequate numbers. Besides we will request the education authority for teachers training as per need assessment. We also request the CRCC/BRCC to take demo classes in our school. We will request volunteer organization Lokadrusti for our teachers' training if required. Plan is as follows:

SI No	Activities	Sub-Activities	Unit Cost	Required Unit (yearly)	1st Financial Year	2nd Financial Year	3rd Financial Year
1	Evaluation		500	3	1500	1500	1500
2	Worksheet		50	75	3750	3750	3750
3	TLM		1000	5	5000	5000	5000
4	TLM (math)		100	75	7500	7500	7500
5	Writing Materials		20	75	1500	1500	1500
6	Lower Black Board		2000	2	4000	0	0
7	Registers, duster, chalk & office materials		500	5	2500	2500	2500
8	Training of teachers		1000	5	5000	5000	5000
Total					30750	26750	26750

12. PLANNING TO STRENGTHEN SCHOOL-COMMUNITY LINKAGE

Quarterly meeting of parents will be organized to share learning progress of children. Where all issues related to children and school will be discussed with the parents. Also activities will be initiated to aware community members on RTE norms. Local Voluntary organizations will be approached to provide necessary support for awareness building and training on RTE.

Sl No	Activities	Sub-Activities	Unit Cost	Required Unit (yearly)	1st Financial Year	2nd Financial Year	3rd Financial Year
1	Printing of Leaflet, posters, etc		1000	1	1000	1000	1000
2	Training of SMC members & parents		3000	1	3000	3000	3000
3	Enrollment Drive		2000	1	2000	2000	2000
Total					6000	6000	6000

13. PROVISION OF CORPUS FUND

1. For overall development and especially for community based activities corpus fund will be developed. Both cash and materials will be received from donors. Donors from individual or institutions will be received.
2. A receipt will be provided against all received from school.

14. OTHER REQUIREMENTS IN THE SCHOOL

Sl No	Activities	Unit Cost	Required Unit (yearly)	1st Financial Year	2nd Financial Year	3rd Financial Year
1	Uniforms for children	400	445	62800	54400	60800
2	Text books		445	by SSA	SSA	SSA
3	MDM	1140	445	178980	155040	173280
4	Cook Salary	1000	2	24000	24000	24000
5	Celebration of Independence Day, Republic Day, Teachers' Day, Sisu Divas, Ganesh & Saraswati Puja etc.			10,000 (corpus fund-Panchayat)	10,000 (corpus fund)	10,000 (corpus fund)
6	De-worming, hygiene & healthy environment building			5000 (health dept)	5000 (health dept)	5000 (health dept)
6	Annual Day & Sports	20,000	1	20,000	20,000	20,000
Total				303780	268440	271480

15. SUMMARY OF SCHOOL DEVELOPMENT PLAN (WITH FINANCIAL IMPLICATION)

SI No	Referring points	Interventions	Financial (2012-13)	Financial (2013-14)	Financial (2014-15)
1	7.B	Teacher Salary	1,08,000	1,08,000	1,08,000
2	8.C	Infrastructural Facility	27,51,000	52,000	12,000
3	9.A	Special Training	78,000	00	00
4	9.B	Migrant Children	4,00,000	4,10,000	3,80,000
5	10.A	CWSN Education	1,40,000	1,30,000	1,30,000
6	10.B	Girls Education	16,000	16,000	16,000
7	11.	Quality Education	30,750	26,750	26,750
8	12.	School-Community Linkage	6,000	6,000	6,000
9	13.	Other Requirements	3,03,780	2,68,440	2,71,480
Total			38,33,530	10,17,190	9,50,230

16. SOURCES OF FUNDING

SI No	Source of Fund	Purpose	Financial year 1	Financial Year 1	Financial Year 1
1	SSA		10,45,530	9,28,190	9,01,230
2	NPEGL	Infrastructure	27,51,000	52,000	12,000
3	KGBV	Girls Education	16,000	16,000	16,000
4	Corpus Fund	Community Linkages	6,000	6,000	6,000
5	MLA/MP Led		0	0	0
6	Panchayatiraj	Celebrations	10,000	10,000	10,000
7	Others- Health	De-worming, etc.	5000	5000	5000
Total			38,33,530	10,17,190	9,50,230

17. RECORDS TO BE MAINTAINED BY SMC

The School Management Committee will maintain the following records in the school.

1. Information Display board
2. Village education register
3. Maintenance of records like asset register, store & stock register, attendance register for students, Bill/voucher register, cash book, ledger, proceeding register, bank reconciliation statement on monthly basis.
4. SMC should make all the above said documents readily available for any type of audit, monitoring, third party evaluation, visit of the monitoring institutes etc

GLOSSARY OF TERMS

ASER	-	Annual Survey of Education Report
CBO	-	Community Based Organisation
CRC	-	Cluster Resource Centre
CREATE	-	Consortium for Research on Educational Access, Transitions and Equity
CSO	-	Civil Society Organisation
CSS	-	Centrally Sponsored Scheme
DIET	-	District Institute of Education and Training
DPEP	-	District Primary Education Programme
EFA	-	Education For All
EGS	-	Education Guarantee Scheme
EWS	-	Economically Weaker Sections
FGD	-	Focus Group Discussion
GER	-	Gross Enrolment Ratio
ICDS	-	Integrated Child Development Scheme
LAMP	-	Learning and Migration Programme
LSG	-	Local Self Government
LSI	-	Learning Support Initiative
LEP	-	Learning Enhancement Programme
MDM	-	Mid Day Meal
MLA	-	Member of Legislative Assembly
MP	-	Member of Parliament
MPLAD	-	Member of Parliament Local Area Development Fund
NCF 2005	-	National Curriculum Framework 2005
NCPCR	-	National Commission for Protection of Child Rights
NER	-	Net Enrolment Ratio
NGO	-	Non-Governmental Organisation
PISA	-	Programme for International student Assessment
PRI	-	Panchayati Raj Institution



PTR	-	Pupil Teacher Ratio
RTE Act	-	Right to Education Act 2009
SCERT	-	State Council of Education Research and Training
SCPCR	-	State Commission for Protection of Child Rights
SDC	-	School Development Committee
SM&MP	-	School Mapping & Micro-Planning
SDP	-	School Development Plan
SHG	-	Self Help Group
SMC	-	School Management Committee
SSA	-	Sarva Siksha Abhiyan
TLM	-	Teaching Learning Material
VEC	-	Village Education Committee
VER	-	Village Education Register

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